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The Politic

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Coming out as Republic

LGBTQ

IN T

"I am proud to be gay. I am proud to be a Republican.

But most of all, I'm proud to be an American," said PayPal co-founder Peter Thiel at the Republican National Convention. The prominent gay Republican's speech was criticized for promoting what many see as a contradictory relationship between the LGBTQ community and the Republican party. But LGBTQ acceptance within the GOP is not new. Several groups have advocated this position for decades, since LGBTQ issues first emerged in elections of the 1980s.

This year is no different, as the presidential race has amplified new, louder voices from within the LGBTQ conservative movement. Greater media attention and controversial statements have brought this movement to the forefront of the election cycle. And while not all LGBTQ Republicans agree, many have voiced their support for Donald Trump. And while this voice has been criticized or stereotyped, it persists nonetheless.

These Republicans were not always under the national spotlight. The first was Former Representative Steve Gunderson (R-WI), who served four years in the Wisconsin State Assembly and fourteen years in the House as a closeted homosexual. Gunderson came out in 1994, after which he was elected to another term as the first openly gay Republican representative.

"I came out because it was important to be reelected as an openly gay person," Gunderson said in an interview with *The Politic*, "[Within the Republican party] the LGBT community certainly had no voice back in the '80s or '90s."

Two years later in 1996, Republican Representative Bob Barr of Georgia introduced the Defense of Marriage Act (DOMA) on the House floor. The law prohibited same-sex couples from receiving federal recognition and withheld the benefits of marriage from them.

"I was the only Republican member of the House or Senate to vote against DOMA," Gunderson said proudly. "I recognized that I had to be honest to my own integrity."

But DOMA passed, and its provisions remained as law for seventeen years until the Supreme Court ruled it

LGBTQ VOICES IN THE GOP

BY **JACOB MALINOWSKI**

unconstitutional in 2013. Although he lost the battle against DOMA, Gunderson's vote inspired the movement to reach new heights.

Interest groups formed to represent the growing community of LGBTQ conservatives. The Log Cabin Republicans (LCR) has long fought anti-LGBTQ legislation like "Don't Ask, Don't Tell" and advocated for LGBTQ inclusion within the GOP. And although the Supreme Court upheld the right to same-sex marriage under Obergefell v. Hodges, many Republican politicians have threatened to overturn the decision.

But Gregory T. Angelo, president of the Log Cabin Republicans, seems unfazed. "I don't lose any sleep at night worrying about marriage equality," Angelo said in an interview with *The Politic*. "It is here, and it is here to stay. In many respects, the marriage and nondiscrimination battle has been won for all but the cleanup."

Joseph Fischel, an assistant professor in women's, gender, and sexuality studies at Yale, notes that Republican support for the LGBTQ community may stem not from more supporters, but rather from a new willingness to speak publicly.

"It is now bad table manners to be homophobic. This makes the GOP easier to stomach," explained Fischel to *The Politic*. "If the Republican party represented your other interests, it's now more acceptable to support them."

While society might accept LGBTQ conservatives, they still have a hard time coming out. Gunderson said that in some places, coming out as gay is "risky at best." Jim Hoft, founder of conservative blog The Gateway Pundit, held doubts about coming out to the six hundred thousand readers on his blog. "There was some fear involved when you're a conservative and you're gay," Hoft explained to *The Politic*. "I didn't know how it would affect my standing in the community."

But following the massacre at Pulse nightclub in Orlando, Hoft felt compelled to come out. "The response from the Democratic leaders when they blamed guns, that really upset me," he said. After coming out, Hoft was surprised to see an overwhelming number of positive responses. Dozens of conservatives sent him supportive messages, he said. Even those who staunchly opposed LGBTQ rights said they would continue to read his blog.

But Lucian Wintrich, a gay artist and graphic designer, did not receive the same response when he came

The idea of "LGBTQ Republicans" contradicts a common narrative in the United States that Democrats are the party of progressivism.

out - as a Republican. Wintrich took photos of young male models wearing "Make America Great Again" hats and posted them on Twitter. His "Twinks4Trump" went viral on the Internet and thrust him into the national spotlight. He received messages calling him "a traitor to the LGBTQ community." Some claimed he had set the community back. Others warned him not to "show [his] face anywhere." In a phone interview with *The Politic*, Wintrich said people would confront him in person to argue politics. Someone even bit him. Wintrich stressed that his critics were largely LGBTQ Democrats.

In today's hyper-partisan political climate, Democrats often appeal to the LGBTQ community by reminding voters of their party's history of support for LGBTQ rights. Democrats attract these voters with a platform of equality and nondiscrimination. The idea of "LGBTQ Republicans" contradicts the narrative that Democrats are the party of progressivism. But some LGBTQ Americans hesitate to join the Democratic party. Doing so, they argue, would compromise their political beliefs.

"The game the Democrats have played with the LGBTQ community for years now," explained Angelo, "is tricking the greater LGBTQ community into believing the only issues that should matter to them are marriage equality and overly-broad nondiscrimination." Angelo explained that LGBTQ voters don't only care about advancing their own rights. They want a government that will reform the tax code, protect national security, and preserve the Second Amendment. "I refuse to be put in a two-issue silo by Democrats simply because I'm a gay man," Angelo said.

His sentiment resonates with many LGBTQ Republicans. Wintrich is also frustrated with the rhetoric of the Democrats. He argued that despite public opinion, the GOP is an acceptant party. "I think it's as inclusive as the left, but they show their inclusivity in different ways," he said. The Democrats, however, exploit their advantage. "The Democrats play a game of identity politics that the GOP doesn't play. The left will put a trans person front and center on screen and have them talk about how liberals are the only accepting party," mocked Wintrich.

In this tumultuous election, LGBTQ Republicans have found themselves at odds with each other. Jimmy LaSalvia, the co-founder of GOProud, a PAC representing conservative LGBTQ Americans, has since dissolved GOProud and now supports Hillary Clinton. "It's our diversity that makes America great in the first place," LaSalvia told *The Politic*. "A vision of America that doesn't recognize that is just not acceptable to me."

LaSalvia sees some parallels between the LGBTQ community and the Muslim-American community. "It hits home for us when we see some groups being targeted politically simply because of who they are," said LaSalvia about Donald Trump's proposed ban on Muslim immigrants. "Our whole lives have been spent being used as political pawns."

Gunderson disagrees. While he recognizes that not everything sits well within the GOP, he also believes Donald Trump is "quite open in support of the LGBTQ community." The Democratic party should be respected for its "voice for progress" in civil rights, he says, but Republicans "need to continue a vigilance."

Pre-election polls have shown that most LGBTQ conservatives support Donald Trump. "He's from New York, he's hired far more gay people than Hillary Clinton," explained Wintrich, a resident of New York City. "We have a presidential candidate who is quite honestly the most pro-gay candidate to run on the Republican platform." Wintrich dismissed the criticism Donald Trump receives for his stance on same-sex marriage. "I really don't care if Donald Trump believes in traditional marriage," he joked. "He's a

The Democrats play a game of identity politics that the GOP doesn't play.

The struggle for conservative LGBTQ people to be heard, accepted, and welcomed by American society is difficult but not futile.

straight guy; that's why he got traditionally married."

Many conservatives say Trump has an excellent record with the gay community, and that the LGBTQ community would be well-represented and protected under his policies.

Jim Hoft agreed that Donald Trump has been "widely accepting of gays over the years," even if his running mate Mike Pence has "different opinions." Hoft said he was impressed with Donald Trump's outreach to the LGBTQ community, especially after the Pulse massacre. Hoft said the Democrats' response, on the other hand, upset him. "There were a bunch of gays that were dead from radical Islam. The Democrats are not taking the threat seriously," declared Hoft.

Iran's threat to LGBTQ rights alarms many conservatives in the United States. The international community has condemned the country's hard-right religious clerics for their persecution of suspected homosexuals. Many LGBTQ Republicans view the nuclear deal with Iran as an implicit endorsement of the country's anti-LGBTQ policies. They reject the notion that the United States should strike any deal with a nation that does not respect gay rights.

Back home, the 2016 presidential race "is a very weird and probably the most theatrical election," said Wintrich, "and there's unfortunately a lot at stake." Where do LGBTQ Republicans fit into the madness? They have received flak from the gay community for not supporting the Democratic party. LGBTQ Democrats have said the Republican National Committee's platform, which rejects the Supreme Court's "redefinition of marriage" and "urges its reversal," bodes disaster for the LGBTQ community. But the party platform is not a binding document. When Gunderson served in the House of Representatives, he did not accept the GOP platform. Instead, Gunderson adhered to some Republican beliefs and distanced himself from others. "The platform assigns a reputation to you that is not sought and is not an accurate reputation of who you are," he said.

LGBTQ conservatives often face scalding rhetoric from their own party. Many Republicans stick to the party platform's positions on LGBTQ rights and reject the premise of same-sex marriage. Wintrich claims to fights this hate with a message of inclusion. "A lot of people recognize the white space for somewhat articulate gay voices in the party and culture," he said.

Some have sidestepped the issue of the party platform, arguing instead that the government does not have the power to resolve cultural divides.

"Any issues facing the LGBTQ community are cultural issues. Not every barrier facing our community is met with a government solution," explained LaSalvia. "As culturally modern people, we need to be inclusive of everybody."

The struggle for conservative LGBTQ people to be heard, accepted, and welcomed by American society is difficult but not futile. "When I got involved in Log Cabin Republicans, I quickly found myself in a room with people who felt like family," said Angelo. "Other LGBT Republicans who felt the same way about national defense, tax reform, and yes, marriage equality."

The 2016 election has come to an end, but this group of Americans will not. Political posturing aside, LGBTQ Republicans only ask for acceptance of who they are.

"I'm just normal," said LaSalvia, matter-of-fact and proud.

This piece was written prior to the 2016 presidential election.

Breaking from A Locked-In Practice: Shrinking Confinement in Connecticut's Prisons

BY **ARKA GUPTA**

"0-1-A-0-5-3-2, that was my identity"

For 20 consecutive days, George Chochos '16 M.Div. was just one of 80,000 inmates serving in solitary confinement. Depending on their classification, inmates can spend up to 23 hours a day confined to a six-by-nine foot cell. In an interview with *The Politic*, Chochos described the cramped atmosphere of a prison cell.

"Imagine a room being the size of a big closet. When I reached out my hand, and keep in mind I'm only 5' 7, I could touch both sides of the wall. Being alone with oneself for a long period of time…It's psychologically draining," he said. "You could literally start to hear voices, find yourself talking to yourself. You feel like the walls are closing in. You have to redefine reality in a way that allows you to have some defense mechanism against the isolation."

Chochos, a recent graduate of the Yale Divinity School, has a unique perspective on the issue of solitary confinement. After experiences in prisons such as Sing Sing Correctional and Clinton Correctional (the facility in which he served 20 days in solitary), Chochos finally settled into the higher-education program at Eastern New York Correctional Facility. He was able to pursue a degree through the Bard Prison Initiative, earning a Bachelor of Arts degree in Social Studies. While Chochos has moved beyond what he terms his "traumatic" solitary confinement experience, many inmates across the country still face these conditions.

The Connecticut prison system does not recognize the term "solitary confinement," instead employing a practice referred to as "administrative segregation." Karen Martucci, director for the External Affairs Division of the Connecticut Department of Corrections, clarified the term for *The Politic*.

"The public in general will use the term solitary confinement attached to a variety of definitions. The terminology itself may give a layman person an idea that there is somebody locked away from everyone, that is isolated. We don't use that in the state of Connecticut," said Martucci.

In contrast, United States Supreme Court Justice Anthony Kennedy equated the two terms in his concurring opinion in the 2015 case Davis v. Ayala.

"Ayala has served the great majority of his more than twenty-five years in custody in 'administrative segregation' or, as it is better known, solitary confinement," wrote Kennedy.

While the relationship between the terms "solitary confinement" and "administrative segregation" differs considerably depending on who you ask, this article will refer to the practice as it is known in Connecticut, administrative segregation.

The Association of State Correctional Officers (ASCA) and the Arthur Liman program at the Yale School of Law recently published a report titled Time in Cell. The report offers a new perspective on administrative segregation and details national solitary confinement trends across prisons in the United States.

From the fall of 2011 to the fall of 2014, the median change in the use of administrative segregation for male inmates was a 0.18 percent decrease, as compared to Connecticut, which

The Connecticut prison system does not recognize the term "solitary confinement."

had a 0.4 percent decrease. Furthermore, Connecticut is one of a handful of states that maintain administrative segregation rates under 1 percent for male inmates. Seemingly at the forefront of administrative segregation reform, Connecticut is addressing this old issue in a new manner. Different sources debate whether the Connecticut prison system has been ahead of the reform curve, or if there is still room for improvement.

In addition to profiling the Connecticut prison system, Time in Cell collected data from 47 jurisdictions across the country in order to gauge consistency in policies regarding placement of inmates into administrative segregation. President Barack Obama cited the Time in Cell report last January in a Washington Post op-ed titled "Why we must rethink solitary confinement." A Department of Justice report also used the data in addressing prison reforms for which Obama advocated.

"Many states were ahead of federal reforms," said Judith Resnik, Arthur Liman Professor of Law at Yale Law School and a contributing author of the report. Resnik told *The Politic* that the ASCA-Liman report was an important step in what she described as "a long series of projects meant to reduce the number of people in solitary confinement."

According to the report, many policies focused on criteria for entering administrative segregation, but few focused on procedures for leaving. Prisons profiled in the report varied in their standards of what behavior qualifies a sentence of administration segregation. The report also found inconsistencies regarding the person responsible for determining the ultimate placement of the inmate. Most prisons agreed that administrative segregation was a useful tool to protect the general prison population.

Many prison officials in the state of Connecticut share this attitude. Rudy Demiraj, president of the local American Federation of State, County and Municipal Employee Union (AFSCME), which includes prison correctional officers, believes that the

practice is important for inmate safety.

"The intent of administrative segregation is to separate the most violent inmates from the general prison population. It's a tool used to keep other inmates safe," said Demiraj in an interview with *The Politic*.

Martucci listed behaviors that would make an inmate worthy of placement into administrative segregation, such as assault on a staff member, fighting with other inmates, or use of a homemade weapon. The practice of segregation for violent inmates in the state of Connecticut coincides with larger national trends.

"The prevailing narrative is one where solitary confinement can be used in instances of clear physical danger," Korinayo Thompson '18, Advocacy Chair and Director of Outreach for the Yale Undergraduate Prison Project (YUPP) said in an interview with *The Politic*. "[But] even in those cases, it does harm to the individual being isolated."

YUPP is a student group dedicated to a variety of reforms for the criminal justice system, which includes advocating against administrative segregation as a prison tactic. The organization tasks itself with raising awareness for those experiencing administrative segregation. It launched its inaugural demonstration in 2014. For 23 hours, students occupy a taped-off area equivalent in dimensions to an administrative segregation cell. Demonstrators remain silent, seated patiently for the duration of their "sentence." Through this silent demonstration, YUPP members attempt to raise awareness for inmates enduring sentences in restrictive housing.

"This demonstration is a reminder to the community at large that there is an individual living on the margins, subjected to what many believe to be cruel and unusual punishment," said Thompson.

Groups like YUPP have been active in attracting attention from the media, the government, and prison officials alike, by publicly demanding that they address issues with administrative segregation.

In recent years, prison officials have actually reached out to outside parties in order to cooperatively confront the issue of administrative segregation—Time in Cell is one example of this phenomenon. The report's collaborator, the ASCA, is an organization composed of the directors of state prison systems and the federal system, as well as of some major city jails. Time in Cell reflects how prison administrators have joined with academics and others to limit the use of solitary confinement, administrative segregation, or—as many prisons call it—"restrictive housing." ASCA established a committee specifically tasked with addressing segregated housing in 2012, and in 2013, it adopted guidelines limiting the use of restrictive placements.

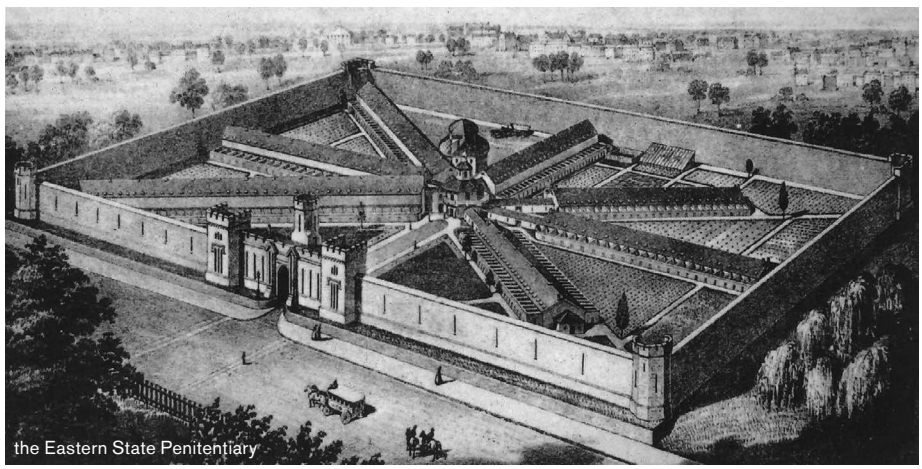
"People who run prisons have come to understand that large numbers of people in extended restricted isolating conditions is now a grave problem to be solved. In the past, the sense was that placing people into such settings was a solution to a problem," said Resnik.

While administrative segregation was once thought of as the ideal answer to the question of troublesome inmates, it now has a negative reputation that both prison administrators and prison reform advocates are trying to address.

Administrative segregation originated in the 19th century, when Anglicans and Quakers sought to establish a new reform system that was, in their view, more humane than the conditions of overcrowded prisons. In 1829, they opened Eastern State Penitentiary, constructed solely of single cells meant for isolation. In theory, this separation would permit inmates to reconcile their crimes with God and seek penitence (hence the term penitentiary).

Instead, isolation drove many inmates insane.

When renowned author Charles Dickens visited Eastern State Penitentiary, he was aghast by the conditions



the Eastern State Penitentiary

of the men he witnessed.

"I believe it…to be cruel and wrong…I hold this slow and daily tampering with the mysteries of the brain, to be immeasurably worse than any torture of the body," said Dickens.

After suffering through the administrative segregation experience, George Chochos is painfully familiar with the full extent of mental health deterioration associated with it.

"It's a form of PTSD. It really is," he said.

Countless scientific studies have warned against administrative segregation due to the psychosocial distress entailed. Dr. Atul Gawande, renowned public health expert, published an article in The New Yorker which argues that social isolation tentatively leads to a loss of interactional skills. In the article, Gawande makes a connection between the treatment of United States inmates in administrative segregation, and United States prisoners of war subjected to the treatment of violent hostiles; both experience a deterioration of social skills due to isolation.

Gawande adds that prisoners in administrative segregation "begin to lose the ability to initiate behavior of any kind—to organize their own lives around activity and purpose."

With leading scientists decrying the detrimental psychosocial effects of administrative segregation, how does Connecticut's correctional program view it?

According to Demiraj, the Connecticut administrative segregation program varies significantly from those of other states.

"That's not the case in Connecticut," said Demiraj when asked if Connecticut inmates are suffering from this psychological affliction. "The inmates have clear contact with other inmates on a daily basis, and are allowed to interact with other inmates in this program."

In fact, Demiraj argued that the educational programming and resources available to these inmates are immensely beneficial, to the point that, he says, many inmates choose to stay in administrative segregation.

The classroom was, "[The] only place where our humanity was validated."

Meanwhile, Martucci acknowledged that a restrictive environment is not optimal for integration back into society.

"The review process is not an automatic placement," said Martucci. "We have a hearing, and review the inmate for the placement. One of the biggest pieces is a full psychological exam."

Inmates in the program also progress through a phased system, which includes educational programming meant to reduce violent behaviors.

The educational programming referenced by both Demiraj and Martucci is a curriculum designed for inmates in administrative segregation, meant to reduce violent tendencies and better prepare inmates for reintegration back into society.

However, the presence of educational programming for inmates does not guarantee full participation. For example, the Time in Cell data highlights instances in which multiple prison systems reported less than 25 percent participation. Additionally, while the programming includes chances for group interaction, a significant portion consists of in-cell education, which limits contact with others.

In contrast, the educational programming for the general prison population yields high participation rates with opportunities to interact with peers as well as teachers. Projects such as the Bard Prison Initiative allow prison inmates to pursue a higher education degree through Bard College. For attainment of a high school GED, tutoring is offered, often in conjunction with volunteer groups like YUPP.

Prison officials and reform advocates agree that education has been shown to improve inmates' prospects of re-entry into society.

Chochos claimed that during his tenure in Bard Prison Initiative, the higher-education program through which he received his B.A., the classroom was, "[the] only place where our humanity was validated."

Not only did this program significantly improve his sentence, but it prepared him for reintegration into society. Chochos said that his educational opportunities during confinement significantly eased his transition to divinity school.

Increased educational possibilities for inmates in administrative segregation provide a chance to ease their prison experience as well as an exposure to opportunities that might otherwise have been inaccessible.

The purpose of the criminal justice system to many prison administrators and reform advocates alike is the rehabilitation of inmates into functioning members of society, and a redefinition of their view of themselves and their role in their communities. For Chochos, that redefinition occurred in the classroom.

"Being exposed to some of the major works in Western Civilization, I saw myself as a citizen in a new way", he said.

He reintegrated into society with a new identity. Not as an ex-offender, not as 0-1-A-0-5-3-2, but rather, as a student vital to his community.

When God Still Lives

A Portrait of Post-Revolutionary Iran

BY **BEHBOD NEGAHBAN**

IN THE BACK OF A RESTAURANT in a Vancouver suburb, I drink with a group of Marxist Iranian dissidents. One of them, Parsa—flushed, stumbling, and portly in the way of a drunk from a Russian novel—asks if I have a right hand. I tell him I do, before he hits me over the head, pours me a shot, and declares I'm only ever allowed a "left" hand and an "ultra-left" hand.

Some of these men came of age during the 1979 Islamic Revolution, some during the Iran-Iraq War, and some directly after. Yet each one risked everything to make Iran secular, socialist, and democratic—before fleeing to the West from imprisonment, torture, and state-enforced disenfranchisement.

Above us are lights that toss a deep purple and, just beyond the bar, a vacant space—for when these middle-aged men decide to dance (and they will dance). But for now they laugh through their throats and trade stories of their years spent defying and denouncing, paving ground for a revolution which they hoped—and still hope—will someday come.

I grew up around these people, with their caustic passion and bluster. They became my family's closest friends after we left Iran for Canada. Yet lately this group and I have grown apart, and disagree on how to undo the despotism of Iran's government, the Islamic Republic. These men either opposed the Iran nuclear deal, kept silent, or nodded cautiously—while I cheered it on. They think international isolation can suffocate the regime until it changes. I think we've seen that tactic under U.S. policy for decades without success.

I say trade and diplomacy can empower Iran's reformists to change the regime from within. They reply—as Parsa slides me another shot, muttering that "sharing is caring"—that it would give billions to the mullahs. They'll buy Ferraris for themselves, they say, and guns to shoot everyone else.

"What do you know that we don't?" I feel them asking when we debate Iran. "What have you really seen?" Not much. And I wonder what I would learn if I did.

"WE WANTED TO CHANGE THE WORLD," Hossein told me. Once a Marxist guerilla, he's now a spiritualist film-maker; the type who mainlines vitamin D for its health benefits. The Leftists who helped create Iran's 1979 revolution, he insists, viewed themselves first as soldiers in a global struggle against neo-colonial Empire, and second as Iranians.

"I knew about Nicaragua," he said. "I knew about El Salvador, I knew about Reagan, I knew about Thatcher, I knew about what was going on in the Soviet Union, I knew about what was going on in the Far-East—it was never national, it was never local. Iran is part of this chain that had to be broken."

"When you think in those terms," he said, "everything you do—you know, breathing, eating, walking, exercising, fucking— everything becomes part of the same story."

And it's a story that once spread across the developing world, when the U.S. would back the regimes that Soviet-funded Leftists opposed. In Iran, those Leftist heroes were the Tudeh, Fedai and Mojaheddin parties, and the villain the U.S.-backed Pahlavi dynasty. The former would slay the latter, so the story went, and socialism in Iran would help usher in socialism elsewhere.

But that's not what happened. Every Marxist revolution needs an industrial working-class and, in the 1970s, Iran's was neither large enough nor willing to comply. Instead the clerics weaponized the religious fervour of the underclass to hijack the 1979 revolution and replace the Shah's regime, not with a secular socialist state, but a brutal Islamic Republic.

So the story collapsed upon itself. And Iran's Leftists— the urban, educated children of the middle class—couldn't stomach that their proletariat was wooed by a gaggle of "backwards" mullahs.

"They lost bad," Hossein said. "Bad, bad, bad. Trumpian bad, you know what I'm saying?" After the Revolution, the clergy didn't have to vie for power with the military, which had been weakened by Leftist guerrilla wars in the north. And the clerics learned their foreign-policy vocabulary—of anti-imperialism, anti-colonialism, and anti-Americanism—from their Marxists cellmates in the Pahlavi prisons.

"The dish is a deep sense of betrayal," Hossein said. "The spices—paranoia, water and salt, excessive pride. What do you get when you cook it?" A fierce hatred for the clerics who hijacked their utopia and a rage stoked after decades spent dwelling on—and living within—a catastrophic historical irony.

The Leftists who helped create Iran's 1979 revolution viewed themselves first as soldiers in a global struggle against neo-colonial Empire and second as Iranians.

These men in the restaurant tell me too that reform in Iran is impossible, its supporters clueless, and the politicians who promise it powerless.

WE LEAVE THE RESTAURANT and head to a hookah bar. My dad laughs as he takes his seat. "We used to translate Hegel with a German to Persian dictionary," he calls out. "Baba," Parsa replies, "I didn't even know what the bourgeoisie was. I just knew it was really bad—so I'd go out and slip notes with socialist radio frequencies into people's houses." Parsa took a job in the regime's literacy program to radicalize the peasantry. "By the end of the school-year I had those sons-of-bitches reading pamphlets," he says. "I was a vanguard of one!"

Later activists, I'm told, also lacked political mentors.

"I believe my generation tried to actually create the wheel again," says Alireza, an impressively charming real-estate developer who also leads two NGOs in Vancouver and works for the Democratic Party in Colorado. During the late 1990s and early 2000s, Alireza was a student leader for Mohammad Khatami's successful presidential campaign. Khatami promised to uphold free speech, ease social restrictions, and open a dialogue with the United States. He uplifted millions of exhausted Iranians with his buoyant promise of change.

I asked Alireza whether he'd felt a link to the generations of activists who came before him. Their experiences had made them depressed, he said. "They didn't want to talk. So I didn't know about their plight, I didn't know about their challenges, I didn't know how they tried to deal with the challenges," he said.

"I was an actor in the middle of a storm not appreciating the nuances of what were surrounding me," he said with a sigh. "It's actually very sad when I look at it."

Doctor Ahmadeyan—once part of Iran's Marxist underground, now a professor at the University of Victoria—tried to explain this inter-generational amnesia. After the revolution, he said, the clerics "intentionally created a series of crises, both nationally and internationally," to purge opposition. The civil war in Kurdistan, the attack on the U.S. embassy, and the prolonged war with Iraq all justified a constant state of emergency.

"It is documented that about 5000 to 7000 have been killed, all activists," said Ahmadeyan, but "it is speculated that the actual number is around 25,000." And that includes moderates within Khomeini's own camp who, "because of their dedication," the regime "sent to the war and got killed."

I used to wonder how these generations of activists became so disconnected. The answer is that the first generation was almost wiped out. And those not wiped out were exiled. "Probably 100,000 activists left the country," unable to rebuild their lives after prison, Ahmadeyan said. "A complete generational vacuum."

If reform is impossible, then the only alternative is revolution. And if revolution topples the Islamic Republic, then the Left never really failed.

AND SO FOR A LONG TIME, Alireza said, the older generation believed their children had "internalized the values of the Islamic Republic of Iran" through its propaganda. The younger generation, they claim, don't know "how dishonest the clerical establishment — all of them — could be."

Now these men in the restaurant tell me too that reform in Iran is impossible, its supporters clueless, and the politicians who promise it powerless. But that prejudice against reform seems ill-founded: Khatami's reforms, while brief, eased censorship — "even Karl Marx books got published," Alireza said — and checked conservative factions like the Revolutionary Guard that grew immensely under the Ahmadinejad administration. Khatami's reforms make the case for more, not fewer, attempts to change the regime from within.

"The history of Iran has had loads of ups and downs," Alireza said, "but most people focus on the downs. After a while, they even start criticizing the ups."

Yet these men don't need proof for their prejudice, because it seems to fill an emotional need. If reform is impossible, then the only alternative is revolution. And if revolution topples the Islamic Republic, then the Left never really failed;

“We failed, but we tried. A lot of us lost our lives because we tried,” Hossein said. “You guys, you don’t even try.”

that Iran’s history and demography might be repainted in colors more pleasing to the educated eye.

“That’s why we got defeated,” Hossein said. “I was ideological myself, but no longer. It’s about politics; you need to be a good tactician.”

“I don’t belong to that community [of ideologues] anymore. I avoid that community. To me, they’re fossils, they’re dinosaurs, they’re dead. They just,” he added, loudly, “carry their bodies around.”

MY FATHER PICKS UP HIS POOL CUE, as Parsa trips over his own. Kaveh stands at a distance from their table in the shadow of a pillar; like part of the scenery. He’s been quiet all night, and his body is sunken and sallow in places one wouldn’t expect a body to be.

My father asks him to “teach [me] something about Iran.” And though he refuses— saying “Iran’s a shit show,” asking “why bother him?”— Parsa decides to bother me anyway.

Kaveh led the Iranian student protest movement of 1999, an uprising that resulted in a crackdown, with hundreds detained and many more disappeared. He was jailed sporadically for three years and tortured for days at a time. He developed two types of cancer, a phenomenon so common in Iranian prisons that a group of North American academics have begged Iran to address it. Now out of jail, but unwilling to endure more agony in Iran, Kaveh lives alone in a basement suite in some morbid backwater of Canadian suburbia. He comes from a wealthy Azeri Turk family, I’m told as we drop him off, and had four hundred million dollars in assets confiscated by the Islamic Republic. We all wonder aloud why he didn’t, just couldn’t, stay still.

Though the old Left was, and still is, blinded by hatred and consumed by ideology, their searing dedication should not be forgotten. Iran needs pragmatism, but it also needs people who can organize and motivate, who can revive the vigor with which the old Left once sought revolution.

“We failed, but we tried. A lot of us lost our lives because we tried,” Hossein said. “You guys, you don’t even try.”

I ALSO SPOKE THAT NIGHT with my friend Kasra, who had just immigrated to Canada for college. Always studying, always grabbing every check, and always — somehow — wearing a tie, he is probably the sweetest person I know. So sweet that when I met him, I heard my father’s voice telling me he was a spy for the Islamic Republic. (I still hear it.) But he certainly has the pragmatism; he reads Machiavelli for pointers on how to crush political rivals and, when I asked him if he thought religion was good for anything, he replied: “Sending people to war.”

And while it seems that Iran’s newest generation is characterized by that pragmatism, I hope for Iran’s sake and my own that they’re half as ferocious as those who came before them.

At the restaurant they sing songs in Persian which they know by heart. And they quote poetry to me that I can’t understand. And they come to me with tears to ask, as Parsa does, that I not be “sentimental about Iran. All our words here,” he tells me, still stumbling, “just stand in for something else.”

POWER POLITICS & PIRATES

INSIDE THE STRUGGLE FOR ICELAND'S FUTURE

BY **RAHUL NAGVEKAR**

"ECONOMICALLY, WE'RE DOING QUITE WELL. HOWEVER, **WE HAVE A MORAL CRISIS.**"

WHEN ICELANDIC PRIME Minister Sigmundur Davíð Gunnlaugsson walked into his run-of-the-mill interview with a Swedish television station in March, he had no idea he would walk out of it a viral celebrity.

In an incident that later hit the internet, Gunnlaugsson was unexpectedly confronted with questions about Wintris, a British Virgin Islands-based company in which he once owned shares. Unbeknownst to him, the Panama Papers leak had identified Gunnlaugsson as one of over a hundred public officials worldwide with less-than-transparent connections to tax havens. He ended up removing his microphone and storming out of the interview.

Soon after the video's release in early April, over 20,000 people–almost one in every 15 Icelanders–were demonstrating in the square in front of the Alþingi, Iceland's parliament, demanding Gunnlaugsson's resignation. He was out of office in less than a week, and his successor Sigurður Ingi Jóhannsson agreed to hold elections six months early, on October 29, 2016.

Perhaps predictably, Gunnlaugsson's centrist Progressive Party took a beating at the polls, falling from 19 seats (out of 63) to just eight. The day after the election, Jóhannsson announced he would step down as prime minister. But with the range of newly empowered parties, from the Progressives' center-right coalition partner, the Independence Party, to the stridently anti-establishment Pirates, it is less than clear who will run this country now.

Despite the Independence Party's victory in the election with 29 percent of the vote and 21 seats, the incumbent two-party coalition lost its majority. This may come as a surprise, since Iceland — which was one of the countries that was worst hit by the 2008 financial crash — has recently been enjoying strong GDP growth, low unemployment, and low inflation.

Sigríður Benediktsdóttir GRD '05, a Senior Fellow at the Yale Jackson Institute for Global Affairs who has served as Director of Financial Stability for Iceland's central bank, told *The Politic* about her country's economic recovery.

"Now things are going superbly well," she said. "We've had growth over or about four percent per year the past two years. People's real incomes increased over 10 percent last year. Tourism increased by 33 percent—that's a two year doubling time for the number of tourists."

Still, the decline in the current government's popularity comes as no surprise to Benedikt Jóhannesson, who left the Independence Party two years ago to establish a new center-right outfit, the Reform Party. Speaking with *The Politic* prior to the election, Jóhannesson said of Iceland, "Economically, we're doing quite well. However, we have a moral crisis."

Jóhannesson made the case that the government had begun to lose Icelandic voters' trust even before Gunnlaugsson was ousted.

"We have a number of systems here that people think are unfair," he said, pointing to fishing and agricultural policies that he believed hurt consumers. But he then summarized the opinion of many of his compatriots on the Panama Papers, saying, "This was, I think, morally the most disturbing single occurrence in Icelandic politics."

Benediktsdóttir explained to *The Politic* that through his holdings in Wintris, Gunnlaugsson had a stake in the assets of Icelandic banks that had failed in 2008.

She said that during his time as prime minister, "He had been involved in negotiating an understanding between the government and old bank claim-holders to unwind these banks' estates. And he was a claim-holder. So there was a little bit of a conflict of interest."

She continued, "Maybe this wasn't the worst thing in the world. Maybe it didn't change anything. But at the same time, we would really like to see everybody holding themselves to higher standards, because now we're just skeptics. And we always paint these incidents with the harshest colors, because of the [financial] crisis."

Gunnlaugsson was not the only Icelandic politician tainted by the Panama Papers: Two other ministers, including Independence Party leader Bjarni Benediktsson, were also linked to questionable tax practices.

Ironically, Benediktsson's political future—possibly as Iceland's next prime minister—might now be in the hands of the pro-transparency Reform Party, whose seven seats could place them in a much-coveted kingmaker position.

Reacting to the election results, Benediktsson suggested that the Independence Party's first-place finish gave

"THIS WAS, I THINK, MORALLY THE MOST **DISTURBING SINGLE OCCURRENCE IN ICELANDIC POLITICS.**

"WE FEEL IT IS IMPORTANT TO BACK THE POWER OF THE 'DEMO-' IN DEMOCRACY"

it a mandate to lead coalition talks. But on Monday October 31, Jóhannesson told reporters that the Reform Party would not support a continuation of the outgoing Independence-Progressive coalition.

This makes it highly likely that Iceland's next administration will be supported by at least one of the four current opposition parties. And perhaps none of these parties attracted more international media attention during the campaign than the Pirates.

As its name might suggest, Iceland's Pirate Party is not a traditional political force. Its origins lie in a global movement for copyright reform. Digital freedoms still occupy a prominent place in its platform — the party supports a right to internet privacy and favors granting Edward Snowden Icelandic citizenship.

From The Guardian to TIME, many media outlets have referred to the Pirates as "radical." But in an interview with *The Politic*, the party's unofficial leader Birgitta Jónsdóttir —who calls herself a "poetician"— begged to differ.

"I don't see us as a very radical party," Jónsdóttir said. "We're pragmatic. We feel it is important to back the power of the 'demo-' in democracy. We want to take power from the powerful and bring it back to the people. We want to deal with corruption, which is the reason why we're having these early elections. That's how radical we are."

Jónsdóttir went on to observe, "The term 'radical' always comes with this sense of danger. Maybe it is dangerous to separate the traditional banking system from the casino banking system. Maybe it is dangerous to say we should not socialize private debt. If it is so," she said with a laugh, "then we are very radical."

She did not, however, object to the characterization of her party as populist.

"I want to remind people that populist can mean an expression of the will of the general public," she said. "It can mean that you are inspiring people to participate, you are inspiring people that there is hope for the future."

Jónsdóttir also told *The Politic* that the Pirates' structure inverts that of traditional parties, explaining that through community meetings and an online voting system, Pirate Party members can approve of policy proposals suggested by any Icelander. Then, it is the responsibility of MPs — who might be the ones writing policies in other parties — to put forth accepted ideas from ordinary citizens to a parliamentary vote.

While it may be hard to place the Pirates' ideology, they are undeniably anti-establishment, and in the immediate aftermath of the Panama Papers scandal polled as high as 43 percent. On election day, they finished in third place with 14 percent, but nonetheless almost tripled both their share of the popular vote and their representation in the Alþingi, going from three to 10 MPs. Jónsdóttir and other prominent Pirates appeared pleased with the gains and called for multi-party cooperation to unseat the incumbent administration.

Beating the Pirates for second place was the Left-Green Movement, a democratic socialist party whose 16 percent vote share and 10 seats represented the second-best result in its nearly two-decade long history. Like Jónsdóttir, Left-Green leader Katrín Jakobsdóttir was proud of her party's success and the possibility for a new government in Iceland.

The Left-Greens agree with the Pirates and two other center-left opposition parties — the social liberal Bright Future and the Social Democratic Alliance — on a number of issues, particularly the need for increased investment in healthcare. These four parties had expressed interest in governing together as a post-election coalition, but they won a total of only 27 seats (five short of a majority). Now, some or all of them might work with the Reform Party or the incumbent parties to produce a stable government.

Especially if it includes the current opposition parties, Iceland's next government could provide hope for supporters of the nation's unique citizen-led constitutional reform process, which had its origins in the popular response to the financial crash.

Noting that signs of trouble in Iceland's major banks prior to their 2008 collapse often went unaddressed, Jónsdóttir said of the crisis, "We Icelanders realized that everything we had put our trust in had failed us. That was not only the banking sector; it was the media, the academia, the politicians, the supervisory authorities. It was a massive wake-up call. People were in total shock. And they lost their trust in our system."

Jónsdóttir told *The Politic*, "[In 2008] I was part of a think tank that asked: 'What do we need to do to create a new Iceland?' And eventually we reached the conclusion that we needed a new constitution."

That cause was soon adopted by protesters angry with the government's handling of the financial crash. Thousands of these demonstrators repeatedly congregated in front of the Alþingi in late 2008 and early 2009, throwing skyr (yogurt) at the building and banging pots and pans in what came to be known as the Kitchenware Revolution.

As a result of these protests, early elections were held in April 2009. The center-left coalition that won the vote, comprising the Social Democratic Alliance and the Left-Green Movement, endorsed a plan for constitutional reform.

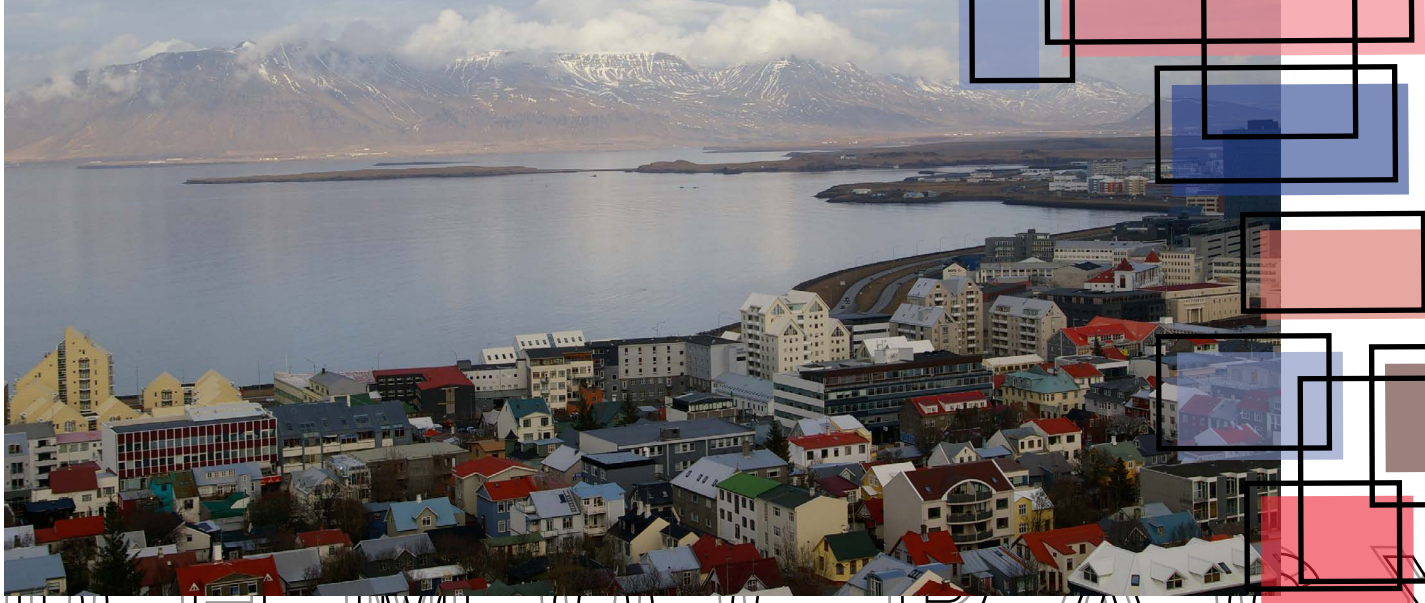
"It started off with two meetings where around 1,000 people, most of them randomly selected from the national registry, were invited to come and talk about what they felt needed to be in our collective social agreement," Jónsdóttir recalled.

"There was then a process where anybody could run to be a member of a Constitutional Assembly," she said. Over 500 Icelanders applied, and in November 2010, voters elected 25 of them to serve in the assembly.

"In four months, [these 25 individuals] drafted a new constitution," Jónsdóttir said. "Of course, these people were different from one another. They did not all share the same values. But they tried to remain loyal to the spirit of what had come out of the earlier meetings. And every time they wrote an article, they put it on Facebook, they made it accessible on the web, so that anybody could bring forward an opinion on it, offer an amendment, or offer opposition to it."

Speaking with admiration for this semi-crowdsourced constitution-writing process, Jónsdóttir said, "People could come and meet these

"WE WERE HEALING, MAYBE BUT IT OPENED UP A WOUND"



representatives, call them, email them. They were extremely accessible, and all of their meetings were open, and streamed."

Despite winning the public's approval in a non-binding 2012 referendum, the draft constitution was not enacted by the Alþingi.

"That complete failure of the traditional parties [to implement the new constitution]...I can't even describe my disappointment," Jónsdóttir told *The Politic*.

After Iceland's 2013 parliamentary election, which brought the current Independence-Progressive coalition to power, the new constitution slipped off the list of government priorities. But the same election also marked the debut of the Pirate Party, which has continuously advocated for the new constitution over the past three years.

By the time of the 2016 election, all opposition parties included a plank in their platforms for the implementation of the draft constitution. Speaking ahead of the Saturday, October 29 vote, Jónsdóttir said of the Pirates' success in pushing the issue of constitutional reform, "We are the party that currently only makes up five percent of the parliament. It just goes to show that with the right planning, the right intuition, and a strategy, you can inspire a lot of action."

For all of the media excitement about the Pirates and their supposedly radical ideas, it remains to be seen whether they will make it into Iceland's next government. But there does seem to be a general consensus that that Icelandic politics needs fundamental and not superficial change.

"There was a lot of loss of trust [after the financial crash], and the trust has not been regained at all," said Benediktsdóttir. "In many ways, the fact that our prime minister showed up in the Panama Papers just increased the mistrust. We were healing, maybe, but it opened up a wound."

Prior to the election, Jóhannesson had not indicated whether he would collaborate with the Pirates or other current opposition parties. But in his interview with *The Politic*, he did acknowledge Icelanders' desire for solutions to what he had previously termed the country's "moral crisis."

"There's a call for new politics," he said. "It's a call for more of a conversation between the people and the politicians, a conversation between the different political parties. Not the politics of the ruling party trying to ram everything down the other people's throats."

If anyone, it was Jónsdóttir who expressed confidence that meaningful change, however slight, had occurred in Iceland over the past eight years. "Things have not changed as quickly as many of us would like," she admitted, "but there has been an absolute shift in awareness."

Jónsdóttir explained, "We actually had two ministers resign during this term. Before [the financial crisis], nobody ever resigned. There are just greater demands for accountability."

And as a longtime digital activist who in 2010 helped publish the material from U.S. solider Chelsea Manning — including footage of an apparent American airstrike on Iraqi civilians — that made WikiLeaks famous, Jónsdóttir told *The Politic* that whistleblowers had played a crucial role in holding powers that be to account, whether in Iceland or elsewhere.

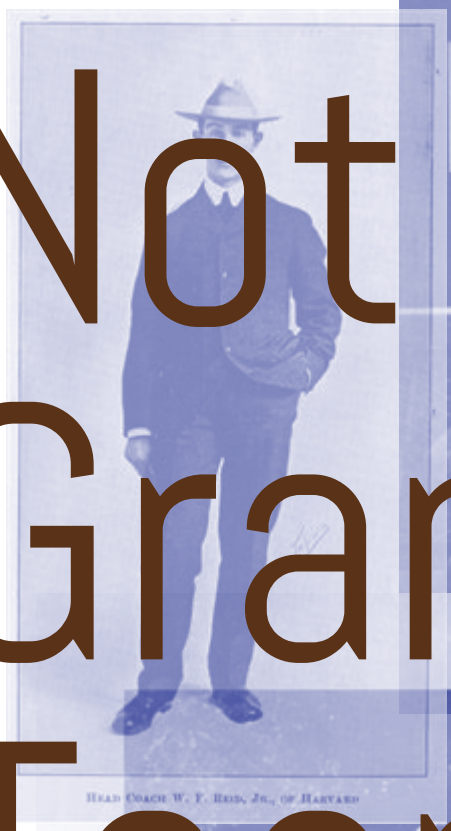
And when the Panama Papers were leaked, their revelations led to an election campaign that Icelandic media has described as "colorful, and certainly memorable." In some ways, history has already been made: With 30 women among its 63 members, the new Alþingi will be Europe's closest to gender-equal parliament.

As of the date of publication, Icelandic President Guðni Th. Jóhannesson had presented Bjarni Benediktsson, leader of the Independence Party, with a formal mandate to initiate coalition formation talks. Additionally, the Reform Party and one of the opposition parties, Bright Future, announced that they would work together during coalition negotiations.

Still, Iceland's 330,000 citizens might have to wait for weeks of talks before they know whether or not a change of government is coming to their divided island.

Not Your Grandfather's Team

Yale Football Embraces Tradition with New Outlook



BY **SARAH DONILON**

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Each Tuesday at noon,

Tony Reno, Yale's head football coach, holds a press event at Mory's. He sits in a place that celebrates "Old Yale"—the restaurant was founded on campus in 1849. Dozens of portraits of former football players hang on the mahogany walls around him.

"This year, our record doesn't indicate how well I think we can play, for a variety of reasons. You can put your finger on probably three or four different things that are affecting the outcome of this team," Reno said. "But the bottom line is this: that's in the past, and we need to worry about what we can focus on today and in the future. Obviously, my focus and their focus is how we can be the best possible team today."

Reno has been Yale's coach for nearly five years. He leads 99 players and 12 assistant coaches. The weekend before the press lunch, Yale had lost to Penn 42-7.

Three weeks after, Reno will travel with the team to Cambridge for the Harvard-Yale game, the Ivy League's biggest sporting event of the year. Harvard and Yale first competed in 1875. Yale has since won 65 games, lost 59, and tied 8. For the last ten Novembers, however, Yale has lost every game to its Crimson rival.

Two years ago, Reno started numbering the teams. Number one starts in 1872, when the team was founded. This year's team is number 144.

"I want our players to understand that they are a small piece in an incredible history and tradition of Yale football," Reno said in an interview with The Politic. "As a football family, we need to continue to grow and get better."

This year, the team is struggling. In an October game against Lehigh, Yale allowed 63 points—tied for an all-time team worst.

The Yale fans of today may look at their team's losses and forget it was here that football took shape as a sport nearly 150 years ago.

"Yale was a powerhouse," John Miller, author of The Big Scrum: How Teddy Roosevelt Saved Football told The Politic. "It was dominant in two ways: first was because it had a really good team that did a lot of winning. And second was because of Walter Camp."

Walter Camp, class of 1882, is considered the "father of modern football." A Yale graduate and New Haven resident, Camp played football at Yale and later served as the team's head coach. He helped define the rules of the game, and invented the quarterback position and the line of scrimmage.

"Camp would claim all the things football promotes—discipline, even in some ways the physicality—was the kind of hardening that boys would need to become effective males in corporate life," Julie Des Jardins, professor of history at Baruch College and author of Walter Camp: Football and Manhood in America said in an interview with The Politic.

"It's sort of easy to make that claim when Yale was so much better at football than everybody else," she said. At that time, Des Jardins said, great football players often went on to become successful businessmen. Camp could persuasively argue that their success came from the values they learned on the Yale team.

Head Coach Tony Reno

photo by Alice Oh

"Yale was a power-house"

Herb Hallas '59 sat on the bleachers

of the Yale Bowl watching the game against Dartmouth in the rain. The players ran onto the field while the Yale Precision Marching Band played pop song covers with gusto.

Hallas played on the Yale team as a left halfback and safety in 1956, the first season of the Ivy League. He holds a school record for his 94-yard punt return—a feat, a friend of his added, that is sometimes listed in the programs. As Hallas watched his old team play Dartmouth sixty years later, he reflected on how the sport has changed since he played in an interview with The Politic. For one thing, he said, the stadium would have been sold out when he was playing. It was mostly empty that day.

"Football was a religion," Joel Alderman '51 said in an interview with The Politic.

"Traffic would be lined up and down Route 34 for miles and miles," Rich Marazzi, author of A Bowl Full of Memories: 100 Years of Football at the Yale Bowl, told The Politic.

Most current students are not regulars at football games. Even at "The Game," the annual Harvard-Yale matchup, football itself is often not the weekend's main focus. Though students don traditional blue and white sweaters with the letter Y, many leave the game early. Last year, some students sported shirts reading: "I would prefer if Yale won because that is where I go to school."

Two freshmen told The Politic they were planning to go to Cambridge for the festivities, but asked "did anyone actually go to the football game?" They had heard the Harvard stadium sells out quickly, but they weren't fussed.

"I would like to see larger crowds at the games. I think going Division IAA has affected the prestige of the program," Marazzi said.

"It's sad," Alderman agreed.

But as Penelope Laurans, former Master of Jonathan Edwards College, wrote in an email to The Politic, "You can't compare apples to oranges."

"In earlier times," Laurans wrote, "the student body was much less heterogeneous, there were not 400+ student organizations with people heavily invested in many different activities, people did not watch sports on TV or online to nearly the same degree."

"If 2,000 students come out to a Yale football game it looks as if there is a

puny number in the Bowl. But what other student organization gets 2,000 student fans (or to one or sometimes two games many more)—beyond men's ice hockey or an occasional men's basketball game?" she asked.

Some students do take an interest in sports. In 2009, a group of students founded the Whaling Crew, a club to encourage school spirit for athletics. Adam Lowet '18 is the current president of the organization.

"There are schools across the country where, even if it's an off-year for that team, football culture is enough ingrained that it is the thing that people do on a Saturday, and everyone across campus—whether they played sports in high school, whether they even like watching sports period—go to the games and go to the tailgates because it is just what one does," Lowet said in an interview with The Politic.

"At the end of the day, we view the role of college athletics not as a way of maximizing the number of trophies, championships, or titles that we get, but as an awesome opportunity to build community across divisions at Yale," he said.Hallas shares this opinion.

"Sports is an educational activity," he said. "The Ivy League is kind of hanging onto that idea. But nationally and culturally, it's a losing idea—sports is seen only as entertainment."

"I don't think dominance should be the goal of the sports program," Miller echoed. "If you believe sports have an educational benefit, and I do, what you want fundamentally is a program that's going to benefit the athletes and help them become better people."

Perhaps by circumstance, the Yale team takes this view, too. The team's leaders have started emphasizing core values the team can always practice, even when they don't win: accountability, mental and physical toughness, competition, family, and belief. Before every lift or practice, the team recites a creed, pledging commitment to each of these values.

One of the team's values is "extreme ownership," a concept that comes from the book Extreme Ownership: How U.S. Navy SEALS Lead and Win.

"The day your team starts to win and takes the next step into your team being great is when every person on your team owns their role to the best of their ability," tight end Sebastian Little '17 said in an interview with The Politic.

"I think we are growing as a team. Obviously our record is not the greatest right now. But each and every week we've taken a step towards that extreme ownership," Little said.

"We harp on process a lot…and we try to avoid the word 'outcome,'" Little said, a plastic band reading "PROCESS" visible on his wrist. The team's creed begins with a vow to "believe in the process."

In interviews with The Politic, it was clear the message has sunk in.

"It's more than results or wins," said quarterback Tre Moore '19. "You gotta focus on the next ten feet ahead of you," said wide receiver Ross Drwal '18. "It's not 'we want to win an Ivy League championship'—'win the practice,'" said defensive back Will Bryan '18. "There's an understanding that football matters, but it's not the only thing in the world," said former offensive lineman Tom Woznicki '08. "We're not going to die if we lose," agreed defensive back Foye Oluokun '17. This balanced attitude is different from old ideas of physical domination.

"Better make a boy an outdoor savage than an indoor weakling," Camp used to say.

Even seventy years ago, Bill Conway '49, who is the oldest living former captain of the team, told The Politic, an alum used to tell the players, "When you are in New York on the street and you walk by somebody from Princeton you played, you want to say, 'I beat you, you son of a bitch!'"

"I've been entrusted to build upon

the tradition and legacy of Yale football, which is the number three all-time winning program in college football history, a program that has produced not only professional athletes but extraordinary men in all different fields," Reno said.

The team has not won a championship since 2006. But Reno has left his mark on the team.

"We have a real plan. A lot of football teams say they do things but there's really not a plan," he said.

Since starting as head coach in 2012, Reno has started two programs to support the players: an academic program and a leadership program. In almost every exit interview, Reno found that seniors agreed on one thing they wish they had done better: time management. Reno worked with the former Dean of Admissions Jeff Brenzel, former Dean

of Yale College Mary Miller, Penelope Laurans, and Director of Athletics Tom Beckett to put together an academic support program. Reno can rattle off academic resources on campus faster than most students can—the Writing Center, office hours, student tutors, residential college services.

Reno also designed a leadership program with General Stanley McChrystal over six months of meetings.

"If you go to school at Yale, there should be a level of leadership—a little more is expected of you," Reno said.

Reno explained that the players start the program as freshmen and are incrementally given more and more responsibility.

"By the time they're seniors, they are entrusted in leaving a legacy, to help make the jersey they wear better for the next guy who wears it," he said.

"We need to represent three different things," kicker Brian Dolan '20 said in an interview with The Politic. "The name on the front of our jersey, which is Yale; the name on the back of our jersey, which is just our family; and then Yale football as a program." For Dolan, those things fuse. His father, Yale class of 1982, played on the team.

When asked what was special about the Yale football team, the players responded almost unanimously: family.

"You immediately come here, and you feel like you're part of the Yale family," Oluokun said.

Moore appreciated the close relationship the coaches forged with him during the recruiting process. They sent him handwritten letters, came to watch him at his high school basketball games, and had dinner at his house. He knew he wanted to come to Yale when Reno talked told the prospects that the team was "bigger than football."

"It's raising men for the future," Moore said. "He reminded me a lot of my dad in the way that he talked."

"We work together to raise these young men," Reno reflected.

"You immediately come here and you' a fa

Walter Camp believed

football hardened boys into men. In the late 19th century, he belonged to the first generation that had not fought in the Civil War.

"White, college educated males had not had a war to harden them," Des Jardins said. Adding to this insecurity were recessions in 1873 and 1893. Des Jardins explained that the men of Camp's generation also felt their power threatened by immigrants and women.

"It's not a coincidence that this is the moment when Walter Camp decides to basically create a game that simulates war on a simulated battlefield," Des Jardins said.

The sport was so rough that many young men died on the field in Camp's time—at least 45 between 1900 and 1905. At the request of President Theodore Roosevelt, a proponent of "rough sports," Camp changed the rules of the game to make it safer.

Beyond the physical roughness, there are also planned strategies and clear delineations of offense and defense. Des Jardins noted that the newspaper roundups of the Harvard-Yale football game could be confused for coverage of the Spanish-American War.

"There are a lot of analogies between war and football," Little said.

Even now, each year the rising senior class takes a weekend trip to the Gettysburg battlefield.

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Though echoes of Camp's football philosophy remain, the comparisons to war now are less about physical strength and more about teamwork.

"In one of the battles, soldiers stood next to each other in twelve inches of rain, and they had one of their brothers, the other soldiers, on their right and one on the left," Little recounted. The players talk about doing their "one eleventh" on the football field—doing their part to support the other ten players. Each of those soldiers, Little explained, was one fraction of the whole.

"It's a life changing experience," Reno said.

"It is like a full time job.

It can feel like the only things I'm doing are football and school," center Karl Marback '18 said in an interview with The Politic. The schedule, which can start at 4:45am and finish as late as 10:00pm on some days, is undeniably challenging.

"But I think that's not the way a lot of people see us," he said. "A lot of people who aren't athletes, I don't feel, quite understand how much we have to do and how difficult it is to balance everything," he continued.

In 2014, as part of a yearly prank before the Harvard-Yale game, a group of Harvard students came to New Haven and posed as Yale students collecting signatures for a petition that would cut funding for the football team (3.2 million dollars in fiscal year 2014-2015). The Harvard student asked a football player if he thought Yale could win that year's game against the Crimson.

"I think we've got a really good shot," he responds in the video. "We just gotta stick to the process."

"Is it the same process that we've used,

"I vow to believ proo

like, the last seven years against them?" the Harvard student asks.

Woznicki, a former player, reflected on the relationship between the team and the rest of the student body.

"I think it's very intimidating going into Yale because you may think you don't belong there academically in that community and your classmates are so unbelievably talented and intelligent and dedicated and it can be very comforting to know this group of people is just like me," he said.

The thinking became, "Even if we don't belong, at least we have our own little cohort," he said. "But it's kind of silly."

Despite high academic requirements for athletes—which is part of why Yale and other Ivy League schools do not have dominant football teams—Marback feels some students look down on athletes, especially when he first came to Yale.

"I really did feel like there were people who saw us athletes as like second-class students who didn't really deserve to be here because we got here through our athletics instead of just academics," Marback said. As a biomedical engineering major, he has taken on a heavy academic workload.

Woznicki believes the division was in some part self-imposed.

"When you have an in-group like that, the things that bond you together kind of define you, and when you're defined as athletes, you're defined against the non-athletes...When you're eighteen [years old], nineteen, it kind of makes sense of the world around you a little bit," he reflected.

Woznicki said this segregation stops some players from experiencing all of the diversity Yale holds. He had the chance to meet new people when he got injured going into his senior year and was unable to play.

"I joke with my friends that I'm so glad I tore my ACL because it allowed me to branch out of that insulated community," he said.

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But former quarterback Lambie Lanman '18 said in his experience there was overlap between the football team and the student body. Since leaving the team, Lanman said in an interview with The Politic, there is "not too much of a difference in terms of how I interact with the student body."

"At some large football programs, there's a sense that major athletes are untouchable. That's not the case at Yale," Lanman added.

Linebacker Darius Manora '17, the team's captain, told The Politic he sees the benefits of a more low-key program.

"It's great going on the street and no one knowing who I am rather than always feeling like 'I am a football player,'" he said.

The students who signed the petition to cut off funding for the team had never seen Yale triumph in The Game. To them, the school is wasting money. And the question is a fair one: Why does Yale lose to Harvard?

"If there was one answer to why, then it would probably be easier to fix," Steven Conn, Yale's Associate Athletics Director and Director of Sports Publicity said in an interview with The Politic.

Of any athletic event all year, the Harvard-Yale game gets the most attention. Most Yale students stay on campus or travel to Cambridge to watch the game, giving up the first day of Thanksgiving break. For Reno, The Game is a game like any other.

"Every coach fights for every game," he insisted. Most players interviewed echoed the sentiment.

"You can't take any game lightly," said Drwal. Little said it is important to ignore the "frequency" and focus on playing well. "We take that with a grain of salt. We play for our family," said Oluokun.

Laurans wrote that the pressure comes with the territory.

"Sports are unique because Ws and Ls [wins and losses] are so public," she said. "You can act in a bad play which gets horrible reviews and which over five performances might be seen by a thousand people—but since bad and good are open to critical interpretation it is not quite the same as when you win or lose contests—Ws and Ls are very bottom line. It is something all athletes and coaches cope with."

Today at Yale, low student turnout and highly visible losses mean that many students know little about the football team save for its losing streak against Harvard.

Alums like Hallas, Conway, and Alderman remember more glorious times for the team.

"Of course [alums] are disappointed we're not winning as many as championships, we're not sending as many people to the NFL. How could they not be disappointed that we're not doing what we used to?" Conn said.

But the scoreboard means something. After losing to Penn, Little acknowledged, "It's tough." "We talk about being process-oriented, but it does seep into the locker room when you lose games like that."

"I think it falls a lot on leadership. It's a personal responsibility of mine every single day I come in the locker room to focus on the things that we have control over," Little continued.

"One of those things is being positive…people feel that, it's infectious," he added.

It is this attitude—that the team can change but the core values do not—that sustains the program. "There isn't a pressure to perform, but there is a standard—a way to wear that jersey and a way to act as a football player—when you're playing for Yale football," Manora said.

"That's obviously doing everything you can to leave the jersey better than you found it and committing yourself to excellence on and off the field, conducting yourself in a manner that the score doesn't have on the outcome on how you are as a person and how you play the game," he said.

The Yale football program is rooted in 144 years of history. The team still claims to make boys into men, but the definition of a Yale man has changed. Camp's macho ideas now seem outdated. The 144th team has set out its own goals—of teamwork, respect, and hard work—that it takes seriously.

"It all goes back to who we are… our processes, our core values," Reno said, sitting for lunch in Mory's. "If you have a good business structure, you're able to withstand any storm. And right now we're in a little bit of a storm, but our business structure is solid—so we'll be able to withstand it."

WHEN POP MUSIC GOES NUCLEAR

The Explosive Politics of K-Pop in Asia

BY **KUSHAL DEV**

THE FANS HAD WAITED HOURS to see one of the most popular bands in Japan. Tens of thousands of them filled the seats of the Tokyo Dome that night in January 2013. Finally the lights dimmed, save for five spotlights trained on the stage. The five members of the girl group KARA stepped into view and began the final show of their first Asian tour.

But KARA is not a Japanese girl group. All five members are from South Korea. Their songs, however, are in Japanese — written, recorded, practiced and performed in a language completely foreign to the singers who sing them.

International crossover is the norm in Korean pop music, often abbreviated as "K-Pop."

"K-Pop reaches the whole world," said Billboard Contributor Tamar Herman. "There are [K-Pop] events every year in the Middle East, the U.S., Australia, Europe, just bringing the music everywhere."

With a worldwide audience, Korean artists often branch out into different countries. But their approach differs from those of American artists. When Beyoncé tours the globe, "Single Ladies" sounds the same wherever she goes. But if the Wonder Girls, another popular female Korean ensemble, were to do the same, the song would be different. In Seoul, they would sing their hit "Nobody" in Korean. But they would perform the song in Chinese if they toured Shanghai, Japanese for Tokyo, and English for New York City. The English version remains one of Korea's only presences on the American Billboard Hot 100, where it briefly sat at number 76 in 2009.

According to Herman, "K-Pop wants to go international partially because the Korean music market is so small. Korea doesn't have a large population, so idols need to perform overseas in order to make money."

While South Korea, Japan, and China have complex political relations, media has flowed easily and profitably between these countries.

"K-Pop needs to be historicized in the context of Asian entertainment history," Jung Bong Choi, Professor of Cinema Studies at New York University, told The Politic. "In the early 1990s, the Korean cultural phenomenon began with Korean Dramas, especially in China. The drama laid the groundwork for the introduction of Korean popular culture into Chinese society. Later in the 1990s and into the 2000s, the K-Drama craze eventually took over Japan."

The rest is history. In 2011, KARA earned over $60 million in Japanese CD and DVD sales alone. BIGBANG, one of K-Pop's most well-known acts,

made $44 million in 2015, exceeding bands like Maroon 5 in revenue.

At first glance, this arrangement seems mutually beneficial. Citizens of both countries can interact and connect over shared interests, while the artists can make profits and find musical success on a global level. But the disagreements between East Asian cultures run deep. "Each of these countries wants to wield influence on the Asian continent as a whole," said Herman. "Korea wants to be that cultural influencer now, and they've been doing that very well, but every time there's an international incident, that hurts Korean media."

This competition fuels already existing tensions left over from Japan's imperial domination of Korea, China's recent claim on the South China Sea, or the North Korean regime's aggression. The tensions have hurt artists and damaged business cooperation between countries.

The most recent issue concerns Tiffany Hwang, a lead vocalist of Girls' Generation — arguably K-Pop's most successful group of all time. The group records Korean and Japanese versions of their songs. One of their Japanese concerts in August awkwardly coincided with Korean Liberation Day. Hwang uploaded a picture to her Snapchat for thousands of fans to see, with the app's Tokyo geofilter on the bottom. The design had imagery from the Japanese Imperial Flag, which, given Japan's history of imperial domination over Korea, is a deeply offensive symbol to the Korean people — especially on their day of liberation. Though Hwang deleted the picture within three minutes, the damage was done.

"Her career literally came to a halt," Herman said. Hwang lost television roles and sponsorship deals, ending her promising solo career.

Choi emphasized the strong effect of politics on Asian music. "We have to look at the sharp division between political and historical aspects surrounding East Asia, and the economic and cultural dynamics of East Asia," she said. "Japan, South Korea, China, and Taiwan are still hung up on the past, in terms of comfort women, territorial disputes, and more. The past, along with the emerging power of China, create a historical-political issue."

Why, then, is pop music so profitable in Asia? As Choi explained, "The historical-political issues are in sharp contrast with the economic-cultural issues. The cultural flow is the most effective lubricant that keeps the Asian economy going."

Japanese KARA fans weren't thinking about hostilities between South Korea and Japan when they bought their concert tickets. So the cultural economy thrives across international boundaries despite ongoing tensions.

At seventeen years old, Taiwanese-born Chou Tzuyu is new in the K-Pop world. She is a member of TWICE, an explosively popular girl group that debuted in late 2015. In January, at the height of TWICE's popularity, Chou held a Taiwanese flag on Korean television. Mainland Chinese residents quickly accused her of promoting Korean independence. Chou responded with an apology video on YouTube — one that the Taiwanese considered a humiliating recognition of Chinese economic and political influence.

The video received hundreds of thousands of dislikes, many from international fans frustrated to see Chinese politics affecting someone they considered an innocent teenager.

But Chou did more than just hold a flag. BBC reported that Chou may have affected the Taiwanese elections happening then. Estimates suggest the scandal boosted the pro-independence candidate, Tsai Ing-Wen, by at least a percentage point. The controversy ended after Chinese state media issued a statement condoning Chou's actions, saying she still expressed the One China Principle, even if her flag-waving favored the Republic of China and not the People's Republic of China.

But the message remains clear: If an East Asian star makes any political statement (even an unintended one), the backlash can become a political scandal.

Chinese patriotism has caused more problems for K-Pop idols. After an international tribunal rejected China's claims on the South China Sea, several Chinese K-Pop stars voiced their support for Chinese expansionism, using Instagram and Weibo to express their opinions. While their reputations and starpower may have grown in China, Herman claims, "these celebrities have essentially been blacklisted in Korea by the online community."

Victoria Song of the girl group f(x) and Wang Feifei of the girl group Miss A faced the brunt of the criticism. Fei had just released new solo music in Korea, and the reception was very polarized. The song tanked in Korea but saw explosive success in China.

According to Choi, "The Communist Party has complete penetrating power to people's minds through state media... It's natural for the Chinese to think that the South China Sea is theirs. I think that is very absurd from the standpoint of the countries that are being somewhat browbeaten by China—Mongolia, South Korea, Taiwan, etc."

Putting celebrity scandals aside, K-Entertainment has penetrated the largest geopolitical threat to East Asian peace—North Korea.

"The North Korean people, so

"Is it really just natural civilian flow of entertainment? No, it is a **heavily political matter**."

Jung Bong Choi, Professor of Cinema Studies at New York University

many of them are watching Korean dramas and listening to K-Pop, but what's important is that it has to be done in secret," Choi explained. "It is against the grain of the North Korean regime—it is a sedition of mind and a transgression. Therefore, I think this is a serious issue, as serious as North Korea's nuclear power. The power of these people's rebellious minds will have a major impact on the destinies of North and South Korea and their relationship in the future."

South Korea seems aware of this – the country has used K-Pop to protest North Korean nuclear missile tests in the past. In January, the Southern government played Korean songs over the Demilitarized Zone, presumably to heighten the contrast between North and South Korea, and to catch the attention of North Korean listeners.

South Korean intelligence agencies are, as Choi claimed, "sponsoring the trafficking of cultural products into North Korea. It is done under the rubric of Christian charity, humanitarian aid, etc. Is it really just natural civilian flow of entertainment? No, it is a heavily political matter."

When Chinese-Korean relations see strain, so do media relations. The United States and South Korea recently announced the Terminal High-Altitude Area Defense (THAAD) strategy to counter North Korean nuclear aggression.

The Chinese government, seeing THAAD as a threat to Chinese influence in Asia, responded fiercely. China pressured South Korea to drop THAAD by manipulating the international entertainment industry.

As Choi described it, "China nailed the Korean culture industry. A show managed by a Korean company but shown in China was cancelled. Korean stars were asked to stop working on Chinese shows, and the Chinese government delayed its visa process for Korean stars with no explanations."

East Asian aggression has moved off of the battlefield and onto television screens. With politics and music influencing each other, nationalism and political ire have permeated entertainment. The international response to movies, music, and celebrities has been anything but light. Snapchat stories stand in for explosives, Instagram posts for drone strikes, and television still-shots for war declarations.

Peace between these societies hangs in the balance. Could these tensions destabilize diplomacy in the near future? Hopefully not. But until then, fans of all nationalities will attend concerts, buy albums, and watch music videos.

Identity Under Attack

Rethinking the Muslim-American Experience

photo by Harold Shapiro

BY **JACOB LEVITT**

WHEN THE GLOCK WAS FIRED into the back of Alauddin Akonjee's head, he was walking home from afternoon prayer to his wife and six children. As an imam at Al-Furqan Jame Mosque, Akonjee gave a powerful ser mon the day before encouraging listeners to use Islam as a tool of peace to combat discrimination and to fight misconceptions about his religion.

"It was essentially execution style," said Omer Bajwa, Director of Muslim Life at Yale University, in an interview with *The Politic*.

According to a New York Times article about this death, Akonjee was deeply respected in both his Queens community and his hometown of Habiganj, Bangladesh, where he had built a life as a peacekeeper and religious leader. He was left lying in his own blood on the sidewalk.

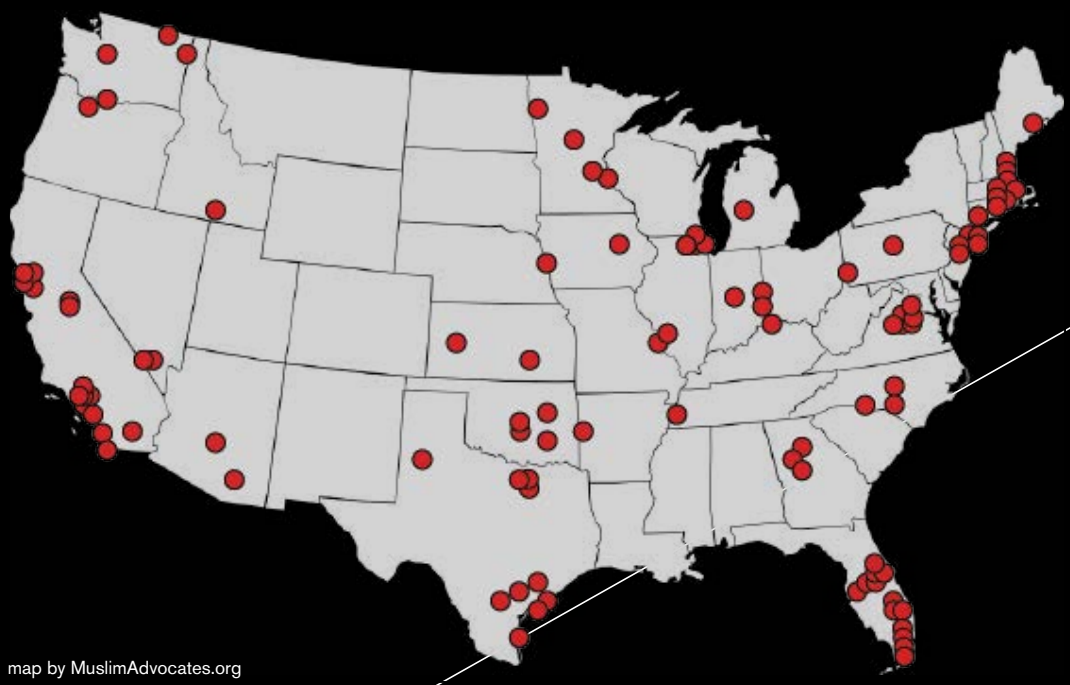
THE MURDER HAPPENED in Ozone Park, a neighborhood of immigrants. Although demographically it is largely Italian-American, a short walk along 101st or Liberty Avenues exhibits the seamless integration of South Asian, West Indian, and Latin American families with restaurants like El Viejo Yayo, the New Thriving Restaurant of Guyana, and nearby Jhal NYC interspersed among decades-old pizza joints. Ozone Park's 30,000 residents makes it small and quiet, save for the sounds of jet engines from bordering JFK International Airport.

Al-Furqan Jame is one of 250 mosques in New York City, a third of which are in Queens. Neighborhoods like Ozone Park, along with Queens Village and Jamaica, share some of the highest concentrations of Muslim places of worship in the borough.

Over the past few months, New York's outer boroughs have been sites of vicious attacks against Muslims. In Queens Village, Mohamed Rasheed Khan was ambushed by three teens while leaving his mosque on a bicycle. Atique Ashraf was struck to the ground from behind outside of his mosque in Parkchester. In Jamaica, Queens, Michael Voyard assaulted people during afternoon prayer, targeting those dressed in traditional Islamic clothing.

Monishee Matin, New York University class of 2020 and a resident of Briarwood, Queens, described the fear now present within Muslim communities. "I had friends who went to that mosque," she said, describing the surreal experience of hearing about the attack. "I live three blocks from a mosque. If it could happen a couple neighborhoods away, what's stopping these people from attacking my mosque?"

The frequency of these attacks in diverse communities has concerned residents and scholars alike. In fact, a map plotting anti-Muslim hate crimes across the U.S. shows that the majority of recent outlashes occurred



map by MuslimAdvocates.org

in large, coastal cities known for their immigrant populations. These findings run contrary to common sociological theory about closeness to difference and acceptance. Zareena Grewal, Professor of American and Religious Studies at Yale, spoke to *The Politic* about this phenomenon.

"What you have in Queens, and what you have in other places around the country, which is actually not typical for American Muslims, are enclaves," she explained. "In other words you have 'Muslim neighborhoods.' It's the big cities where you sometimes find these working class enclaves which are often ethnic or ethno-religious." According to Grewal, these neighborhoods attract people who commit hate crimes because targets are easy to identify.

Non-Muslim people have also been targeted for their physical appearance and skin color. In 2014, a close family friend of Matin's died after being pushed into the subway tracks in the 69th Street Station in Woodside, Queens, a neighborhood known for its multi-cultural presence.

"They caught the lady who pushed him immediately, and when they asked her why she did it, she said it was because she hated Muslim people because of 9/11," said Matin, "but the oddest thing about it was that the guy wasn't even Muslim—he was a Bengali Hindu. He was murdered for simply sharing one single trait of a Islamic terrorist."

Sophia McGee, director of the Center for Ethnic, Racial, and Religious Understanding (CERRU) at Queens College, spoke about the effect of the attacks on her campus. "They're just terrifying for our students, obviously, this is their neighborhood.

McGee founded CERRU with other faculty at Queens College, a school often cited as the most diverse in the country, to try to create a more inclusive campus through dialogue across difference. Along with other community organizations, including those from interfaith backgrounds, CERRU works to condemn and prevent bigoted violence. "It's a lot of fear. People are afraid of difference," she said.

DURING EID AL-ADHA in September, Corey Saylor, who directs the Department to Monitor and Combat Islamophobia at the Council on American-Islamic Relations (CAIR), spoke to the Yale College Democrats and the Muslim Students Alliance about growing Islamophobia in the United States. Saylor heads a legal team that monitors and combats Islamophobic laws in state legislatures.

Although he was not born Muslim, he converted in the 1990s, when Muslims were the victims of genocide in the Bosnian War. At the talk, he noted with melancholy how sympathy for Muslims from that conflict has largely subsided.

"Most Americans are introduced to Islam watching airplanes slam into buildings. Right after 9/11 there was a significant spike in anti-Muslim sentiment; however, none of that was characterized by the violence we see that started in late 2014 and really peaked November or December of last year," said Saylor.

Throughout the majority of Saylor's career, institutional Islamophobia has taken stronger root.

"Oklahoma had a ballot measure on election day, and when you went in to vote, what it said was: 'Should judges in the state of

American Muslims are 6 to 9 times more likely to be victims of violence than any other group

Oklahoma be allowed to consider foreign law or Sharia, which is derived from Quran and the teachings of the prophet Mohammed?"

After a legal battle, this was eventually deemed unconstitutional. According to Saylor, ten states around the country still have laws that were passed with deliberate intention to vilify Islam, and the catalog of Islamophobic statements by elected officials shows no guarantee that these are the last.

Islamophobia can also take on more subtle forms in popular media. A recent report by CAIR showed that Muslims are disproportionately portrayed in television as domestic terrorists.

"There is literally a multi-million dollar industry of content producers, content providers, and content consumers," noted Omer Bajwa, to "create a culture of dehumanizing Muslims, of loathing Muslims, of fearing Muslims."

This uptick in violent attacks is "not a surprise given the American media diet of stories about Muslims," Grewal noted.

In fact, a Georgetown University Bridge Initiative study correlates an increase in violent rhetoric directed toward Muslims to an increase in violence against them. Anti-Muslim violence remains at higher levels than before 9/11; American Muslims are 6 to 9 times more likely to be victims of violence than any other group in the country.

"There's no nuance in your portrayal of this huge group of people. They all are just Muslim, and somehow that equates to something that's bad," McGee critiqued.

"I DON'T ACTUALLY LIKE THE TERM 'Islamophobia," Grewal noted. The statement comes as a surprise. After all, even groups like CAIR and the Bridge Initiative use the term in their names and professional titles. But she explained that using "Islamophobia" separated the prejudice from other forms of racism, suggesting that it is a reaction to terrorism—people assume that terrorism can only be carried out by Muslims. She prefers "anti-Muslim racism" instead.

Grewal expressed her concern that "when we talk about an increase in distrust or animosity towards Muslims, we have to think about it as being part of a larger spectrum where other minorities are also experiencing more racial hostility, too."

When Matin and I discussed the June 12, 2016 shooting of the Pulse Nightclub in Orlando, a well-known LGBTQ establishment, she mused, "if the shooter was, say, Christian, because both Christianity and Islam look down upon homosexuality, would it have been called a terrorist attack?"

Grewal also noted that misrepresentation of bias can actually make it harder to fight hate crimes.

"My brother-in-law was in Indiana and somebody threatened to shoot up the Sunday School where his kids go" she said. "I was on the phone with the FBI dealing with all of this and essentially this man's voicemail message was vague enough that he wouldn't be prosecuted."

The FBI rarely takes preventive measures against these actions. It is unclear whether this speech is protected under the First Amendment. But at the same time, there seems to be an underwhelming response due to the frequency of these threats.

In Grewal's opinion, "There's a kind of politics of confusion here, this suggestion that 'Oh, we don't know what it is,' 'we don't know what happened,' when it's actually quite clear that these things are racially motivated, especially when the perpetrators essentially say something along those lines."

She suggests that anti-Muslim attacks be viewed within the larger climate of racial hostility, as race and religion are often conflated. Islam is racialized by the media, and the American public is unaware of ethnic diversity within the Muslim community. In response, aggressors connect skin tone to religion to terrorism effortlessly.

THE MUSLIM COMMUNITY of the U.S. mirrors the country itself. It is composed both of immigrants from 30 countries on four continents and of natural-born citizens whose family presence dates back centuries; it is of religious leaders and of soccer coaches; of federal judges and of CEOs; of families of all different ages. The diversity of the Muslim experience makes it difficult to craft a single method of combatting attacks against it. But spectators may unknowingly contribute to the deindividualization of Muslim victims.

McGee summed up her vision for the future well. "Here in Queens we're so privileged to be such a diverse community, and I feel like that gives us a really special responsibility to be a pilot for what is possible in terms of how we support each other. The idea is to try to pattern a kind of community culture that becomes the norm- 'this is how the community behaves when things like this happen.'"

LOWER YOUR VOICE

SEXISM DROWNS OUT WOMEN IN PUBLIC SPEAKING

BY **MEGAN MCQUEEN**

"THERE SHOULD BE COURSES in public speaking for women, because they're handicapped, literally handicapped."

Jack Marshall, professional ethicist and speech coach, dismisses those who blame sexism for Hillary Clinton's lack of appeal on the stage.

"The art of oratory was developed for men and by men, and the idea of women public speaking is very recent," he explained in an interview with The Politic. "If a female speaker cannot manage to overcome some of the built-in disadvantages of her gender, that's her problem and her failing."

Marshall's criticisms are not uncommon. One of Clinton's most significant struggles has been with public speaking and connecting with her audience. Commentary on her stage presence—or lack thereof—has provoked debate on how gender plays a role in our assessments of her public speaking skills.

From Youtube compilations of the "Clinton cackle" to derisive tweets like those of Republican National Committee Chairman Reince Priebus ("@HillaryClinton was angry and defensive…no smile and uncomfortable"), coverage of Clinton's speaking style ranges from satire to the close evaluation of her voice's changes in pitch over time. Bob Woodward, lecturer in Yale's English Department and associate editor at the Washington Post dissected her delivery style during an appearance on MSNBC's "Morning Joe."

"She shouts," he said, then suggested she "get off this screaming stuff."

Clinton supporters attribute this criticism to the double-standards applied to female speakers—op-ed writers from The New York Times to Jezebel to the Huffington Post have pointed out how rarely male candidates are penalized in the public eye for raising their voices or for failing to smile for an audience.

While the challenges facing Clinton, the first female presidential nominee of a major party,

"We expect women to be congruent with their gender, and when they are not, we respond negatively."

capture the attention of both the media and its consumers, they are not unique to her situation. Women in traditionally male-dominated arenas, including everyday settings like the classroom, face similar situations.

Bianca Li '19 is well aware of the hurdles facing female speakers. Li has been involved in competitive public speaking and debate since she joined Model United Nations in the 6th grade, and is currently a member of Yale's top-ranked mock trial team.

"There are so many factors I need to consider when I'm trying to decide how to deliver a speech. As a man, you can be almost as aggressive as you want. But women walk a fine line when they choose to go on the offensive," she said in an interview with The Politic. "Sometimes I'll say the same thing [as I had in a prior competition], but if I decide to be more aggressive I'll get a comment saying, 'back down a little, you were too assertive.'"

Former competitive debater Ariel Chin, University of California Davis '17, also attested to the negative commentary elicited by assertive female speakers.

"My coaches always told me never to be too aggressive. If I were facing a male debater, I would consciously match, but not outdo, their aggression," she said in an interview with *The Politic*. "And appearance matters. What women wear matters. We care more how women look; if a woman looks sloppy, it reflects poorly on her. If a man looks sloppy, we overlook it."

For young women like Li and Chin, being a successful debate or mock trial team member requires paying close attention to how they present themselves, lest they lose credibility because of the tone of their voice or the degree to which they display emotion.

"In mock trial," said Li, "if a girl's voice is higher-pitched and she is a louder speaker, everyone will comment on it, saying things like, 'that girl's voice is so annoying.'"

Kelly Dittmar, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Political Science at Rutgers University and Scholar at the Center for American Women in Politics (CAWP), explained in an interview that female speakers are advised to avoid appearing too impassioned.

"Women are told to watch for their tone. Women's tone is evaluated differently. Displaying emotion is also evaluated differently from men. If women get too emotional, that might play into tropes of women being too emotional, of being unstable," she said.

The bias toward female speakers is not isolated to a single profession. A 2011 study done by the John Jay College of Criminal Justice on gender and trial outcomes found that aggressive female attorneys were viewed far less favorably than aggressive male attorneys. The same study provided evidence that juries were more likely to respond positively to attorneys who abided by the norms stereotypical of their gender. For females, this meant behaving passively, while for males, this meant assuming a dominant role. Regardless of how they presented themselves, female attorneys were consistently received less positively.

A study led by Victoria Brescoll, Associate Professor of Organizational Behavior at the Yale School of Management, revealed that among chief executives, male executives who spoke more were perceived to be 10 percent more competent than average by their peers, while female executives who took the floor more were rated as 14 percent less competent than average by both male and female peers. Similarly, powerful male senators tended to speak more often and for longer, while there was no such pattern among female senators.

Kae Reynolds, Senior Lecturer at the University of Huddersfield whose research focuses on leadership, communication, and gender, attributes the different responses to a phenomenon called gender congruence bias.

"Through our media and s ocialization, people are taught to have specific expectations for women and specific expectations for men," Reynolds said in an interview with *The Politic*.

"Our culture has for so long presented us with leaders as men—with masculine qualities like dominance, lower vocal registers, and size—and we have internalized these leadership theories. We associate certain behaviors, personality characteristics, and physical traits with leaders that are stereotypically male. The qualities we expect of women—being caring, nurturing, accommodating—are at odds with those we associate with leadership. We expect women to be congruent with their gender, and when they are not, we respond negatively." Reynolds said.

Dittmar provided a similar explanation for the male advantage on the campaign trail.

"We have expectations of what it looks like, what it sounds like, to be a candidate or an elected official. We also have expectations of what it's like to be a man or a woman. For a man, the two expectations are more likely to align," she said.

Thus women aspiring to leadershipositions find themselves in a double-bind. From the Senate floor to the company boardroom, audiences tend to hold female speakers to a male model of leadership. Failure to exhibit qualities such as assertiveness, dominance, and even physical

strength work against a woman's ability to appeal to traditional conceptions of what it looks like to be a leader. However, should a woman have more naturally masculine traits, or intentionally adopt them, her lack of congruence with society's basic expectations of her gender may decrease how likable an audience finds her.

According to Reynolds, the first step in creating a new, more inclusive model of leadership is challenging the current model. Rather than ignoring the existence of a problem, academic, political and social institutions ought to foster discussion on female underrepresentation in leadership. In politics, this means putting more women in office.

"Because of the Clinton candidacy, I have the sense that this is coming out more — and maybe it's about time," Reynolds said. "We must continue doing research, bringing statistics, and pushing these issues through government policy. For example, the U.K. government has pledged to eradicate the gender pay gap within a generation. The U.K. requires by law for all companies with at least 250 employees to publish their gender pay gap figures. This is change driven by research."

The CAWP at Rutgers University, whose mission is to "promote greaterknowledge...aboutwomen'sparticipation in politics and government and to enhance women's leadership and influence in public life," spearheads efforts in the U.S. to support women in politics.

One initiative backed by the CAWP, along with the Barbara Lee Family Foundation, is the Presidential Gender Watch. The Presidential Gender Watch website provides visitors access to expert analysis of gender on the 2016 campaign trail, including live commentary, or "hot takes," during presidential debates. Site visitors can also view infographics on women in American politics, polling data, and recommended readings.

"We wanted to infuse expert dialogue into the conversation about gender — to track, analyze and illuminate how gender plays a role in the 2016 election," said Dittmar, who is one of the many expert analysts who contributes to The Presidential Gender Watch.

"In the 2008 election, when Clinton ran against Obama, we knew we wanted to pay close attention to what was happening," she said. "There was a serious prospect of a woman nominee. We tracked the gender dynamics of that race internally, but we felt that the public dialogue around gender in the contest lacked depth. We're trying to provide that with Presidential Gender Watch."

Erin Souza-Rezendes is Communications Director of the Barbara Lee Family Foundation, a nonpartisan organization studying the obstacles and opportunities for women running for office, with a particular focus on executive office. The Foundation has researched and studied women's races for almost 20 years.

"We know that women running for office face a litmus test that men don't have to pass: women must be both qualified and likable." Souza-Rezendes said in an interview with The Politic. "Men don't have to be liked to get elected. And men's qualification is assumed in a way women's is not. Men can say they're qualified; women have to show it."

In this manner organizations like the CAWP and the Barbara Lee Family Foundation provide much-needed support to aspiring female politicians. This support includes leadership programs for girls such as Teach a Girl to Lead, a joint project led by CAWP and the White House, mentorship programs for college-aged women, public speaking guidance, and funding for women's political campaigns, including funds specifically to support women of color.

"Men can say they're qualified; women have to show it."

Though many challenges lie ahead, trailblazers like Dittmar are hopeful that with increased visibility, women in leadership will contribute to the creation of a new norm. Meanwhile, the conversation around gender and leadership is becoming increasingly mainstream.

"All politics are gendered. We have started a conversation about what that means, about the negative aspects of putting both men and women into gendered boxes," said Dittmar.

Through the support of organizations geared toward developing effective female leadership models, future generations of men and women will have the opportunities to reshape these norms.

"We can provide to teachers, educators, and parents tools to ensure women's public leadership will be visible in the next generation. Later in life, we hope these women will have less internal barriers. As for men, who often contribute to external barriers to female leadership, having them understand public leadership in a way that is not exclusively masculine is critical in changing those minds," Dittmar said.

The barriers to female leadership are an uncomfortable fact with no easy answers. But as more women seek out leadership positions in their governments and communities, Americans will have to ask just what it is they want from a leader.

loving mothers?

photo by Sanoja Bhaumik

The Open Question of Crisis Pregnancy Centers

BY **VALENTINA CONNELL**

photo by Alice Oh

pregnant? WE CAN HELP

ON THE CORNER of Whitney and Trumbull Street, a green sign with these words catches the eye as it hangs over the entrance to an office building. It designates the Saint Gianna Pregnancy Resource Center, located in the basement.

The Saint Gianna Center is one of four thousand crisis pregnancy centers across the country. CPCs, as they are called, are pro-life institutions that offer guidance and other resources to women who are dealing with unplanned pregnancies.

The Saint Gianna Center, for example, offers pregnancy testing, referrals to financial, medical, and housing aid, information on adoption, parenting supplies, and classes. Its mission stems from Christian ideology, and its motto states "Loving Mothers and Their Children!" The center is three minutes down the road from Planned Parenthood of Southern New England.

The Saint Gianna Center is only open Saturday mornings, since volunteers work other jobs during the week. Descend the stairs outside the brick building to the basement and you'll find yourself in a small entryway. On a rod lining the wall of this entrance hang baby clothes—full outfits, many with the tags still on. Below them, baby shoes are placed in a line from one side of the entryway all the way to the other.

Walk through another door and you'll enter a small room. Children's toys are scattered all over, on chairs and piled against the walls for lack of space. In the next room ten or so children play under the supervision of a volunteer. Their mothers are meeting in a different room. Crosses hang on the blue walls, and there's a table with flyers with titles like "How to Deal with Post-Abortion Trauma," "Abortion Pill Reversal," and "Adoption."

Carolyn Falcigno, Executive Director of the Saint Gianna Center, told *The Politic*, "The center was founded to be an alternative for women in New Haven and the surrounding areas, when they are faced with a pregnancy that's unplanned or a pregnancy that they need a lot of help with, when they don't want to choose an abortion," Falcigno explained.

"We're not trying to talk anyone out of anything," she said. "We just want to help women make informed decisions."

The Saint Gianna Center's website states, "A majority of women considering abortion feel coerced to 'choose' to abort their unborn child - Don't be coerced into doing something you don't want to do - something that is harmful!"

It lists alternatives to abortion, including marriage, single parenting, and adoption. In the event that a woman has already undergone an abortion, however, the center claims it "recognizes that abortion is a traumatic event and provides an individualized program to assist clients in their recovery."

The website states, "Sexually transmitted diseases (STDs), unplanned pregnancy, feelings of being exploited and used, guilt and shame are common results of having sexual relations before marriage."

"Education is the key in ending abortion," Falcigno told me. "Lots of people just don't know what to expect with pregnancy and parenting."

"It's up to the women to move forward with their lives," she continued. "Most importantly, we're here to help."

Falcigno has been with the Saint Gianna Center since its beginnings. She started meeting with "a group of pro-lifers" in 2010, and the center opened its doors on December 12, 2012. The date is special for the group because it is the Lady of Guadalupe's feast day. The Lady of Guadalupe is the patron of the Americas, and the protector of the unborn.

Despite its emphasis on Christian faith, the Saint Gianna Center is an independent 501(c)(3) non-profit and is not affiliated with a particular church. While it serves people of all religions, churches often direct pregnant women and volunteers to the center and fundraise for it.

CPCs such as the Saint Gianna Center take many different shapes and work under different governing entities. While some are run independently, many exist under umbrella organizations, most notably Heartbeat International, Care Net, and the National Institute of Family and Life Advocates (NIFLA). Heartbeat International states that its vision is "to make abortion unwanted today and unthinkable for future generations" and to "renew broken cities around the world, by developing pregnancy centers where abortion clinics are the only alternative for abortion-vulnerable women." The organization provides resources and training to people who want to start pro-life pregnancy centers in their own communities, and even in other countries.

Both Care Net and Heartbeat International have initiatives to offer services to low-income women. The Underserved Outreach Initiative, begun by Care Net in 2003, has developed fifteen CPCs in thirteen cities.

"In many communities, abortion providers outnumber pregnancy centers by a ratio of five to one," Care Net claims on its website. It cites the statistic that "combined, African American and Latina women account for only 27% of the female population in the U.S., yet they undergo 59% of all abortions."

Care Net further explains, "Without access to the important resources provided by pregnancy centers, many women in urban communities are heavily influenced by a devaluation of the life of their unborn child and a perceived lack of support should they choose to give birth."

WITH THE GUIDANCE and resources they provide, pregnancy centers may seem like the perfect stop for women dealing with unplanned pregnancies to consider their options moving forward. However, they are criticized by pro-choice activists for dissuading women from seeking abortions by sharing false information, thus hindering informed reproductive choices.

"CPCs claim to have the best interests of women at heart of their operations, but they shame and mislead women about their health options in an effort to scare them away from choosing abortion," James Owens, States Communications Director at NARAL Pro-Choice America, told *The Politic*.

NARAL Pro-Choice America is a foundation that advocates for reproductive justice with a mission to "support and protect, as a fundamental right and value, a woman's freedom to make personal decisions regarding the full range of reproductive choices." In our conversation, Owens often referenced a report on CPCs that NARAL released in 2015 after carrying out undercover investigations of facilities in eleven states.

According to the report, in 2015, Connecticut had a total of 28 crisis pregnancy centers, compared with a mere six abortion clinics. CPCs exist in every state, with over 4,000 across the country. So far, California and Texas have the most CPCs of any state, with over 160 each.

According to NARAL, CPCs often use false advertising to persuade women to visit their locations in person. Some list themselves in phone books or online directories under "abortion" or "abortion services," to attract women who are seeking the procedure. Others offer pregnancy tests or other services to attract clients.

"If you're seeking abortion care, it's usually something you weren't planning to seek. CPCs find women in these targeted windows of people looking for health care, and inject themselves into women's personal choices," he remarked.

Crisis pregnancy centers often advertise themselves as accredited medical facilities, and women may believe they are meeting healthcare professionals when they enter crisis pregnancy centers. There have even been cases in which people working in CPCs wear lab coats to act as if they are doctors when providing ultrasounds.

"You don't need a medical licence to have an ultrasound," Owens clarifies. "[CPCs] are usually very crafty not to get into any legal issues. They're letting people infer that they are able to provide license-sanctioned medical care."

In the many states that require ultrasounds before women undergo abortions, CPCs convince women that a visit is a valid means to satisfying this requirement. However, CPCs are not under any legal obligation to truthfully relay the results of the ultrasound. NARAL has recorded cases in which CPCs lie to women about how far along they are in their pregnancies during ultrasounds. The farther along a woman is in her pregnancy, the harder and more costly it is to receive an abortion.

Once women enter a CPC, they may be subjected to what NARAL describes as "a variety of coercive and offensive tactics intended to prevent them from exercising their right to choose." These tactics include showing women "shocking" images of fetuses or telling falsehoods about the side effects of abortion.

Some centers warn that abortion often leads to death, infertility, or miscarriages during future pregnancies. Some women are told that abortions can lead to mental health problems such as "post-abortion syndrome" or

"post-abortion stress," neither of which have been recognized by the American Psychological Society or the American Psychiatric Association. Although the National Cancer Institute concluded that there is no correlation between abortions and breast cancer, CPCs often perpetuate that myth.

Though the Saint Gianna Center does not hide that it is pro-life, much of the information it provides on reproductive health it spreads is deceptive. Brochures that the center offers present abortion as a legal option, but they exaggerate the complications of the procedure and invent new dangers.

One brochure insists, "If you think abortion is a safe procedure, PLEASE KEEP READING." Its list of risks of surgical abortion includes "short-term complications," "depression," "death," "substance abuse," "breast cancer," and "future pregnancy risks."

In reality, the risk of abortion complications is low. The Guttmacher Institute reports that hospitalization rate due to complications from abortions plummeted after Roe v. Wade. Recent data indicates that "fewer than 0.3 percent of abortion patients have complications requiring hospitalization." Saint Gianna's brochure, however, states that "about 1 in 10 women undergoing elective abortion suffer immediate consequences, of which one-fifth are considered life-threatening."

The center's claim that women feel coerced into abortions has its origins in studies authored by Vincent Rue, a well-known pro-life advocate. Rue has spread pseudo-scientific evidence on abortion to influence a number of state court cases, according to a March Salon article. Many of Rue's biased testimonies have been discredited by the courts, but his flawed scientific conclusions on abortion, including the Post Abortion Syndrome theory, continue to circulate.

Another one of the Saint Gianna Center's brochures advertises "Abortion Pill Reversal." Medical abortions involve taking two pills over the course of a few days during the first two months of pregnancy. The reversal procedure involves taking a large dose of progesterone after the first pill to negate its effects. Pro-life groups have been advocating for the scientifically unproven and potentially dangerous "abortion pill reversal" procedure, according to an Atlantic article published last year.

EVERY FEW SATURDAYS, Saint Gianna Center leads a prayer service outside Planned Parenthood of Southern New England (PPSNE) in protest of the organization. Planned Parenthood provides services such as STI testing and treatment, HPV vaccinations, birth control, emergency contraception, gynecological exams, pregnancy testing, and more, in addition to abortion services.

The Reproductive Rights Action League at Yale, or RALY, is a student group on campus that volunteers at PPSNE as part of its direct service element. RALY Co-President Sarah Grossman-Kahn '17 and Advocacy Coordinator Maraya Keny-Guyer '19 spoke to *The Politic* about the group's work as Welcome Crew members, volunteers who greet women in the parking lot and guide them into the PPSNE building.

"We act as a positive force for women and keep an eye on the protesters on Saturday mornings," Grossman-Kahn explained. "Some of the tactics that the protestors use are scary. You can get filmed entering the building, which is legal. People yell at you. People call you baby murderers. There was one day last year when someone yelled at us and asked how we could do this before Mother's Day. There's a lot of religious invocation, too, with people reading from the Bible and displaying crosses."

Grossman-Kahn estimated that there are normally ten to fifteen protesters per weekend, but there have been some days when RALY has seen as many as forty. She emphasized that protesters can make women feel unsafe and alone, but Planned Parenthood has a strict non-engagement policy with protesters in an effort to create a more positive environment.

"It's easy to think that in Connecticut, a blue state, most people support the right to reproductive choices," Grossman-Kahn said. "But people don't realize that there's such an active anti-choice movement. People don't realize that abortion is under fire everywhere in America. If the anti-choice movement is this prominent in Connecticut, think about what it must be like in other states."

Planned Parenthood of Southern New England was unavailable for an interview, but Kafi Rouse, vice president of public relations & marketing, provided a statement regarding CPCs.

According to the statement, "there is work to be done to limit the misinformation and manipulation crisis pregnancy centers dispense. Investing in prevention and comprehensive sexual health education is the only proven way to address unintended pregnancies… At Planned Parenthood, we work hard to make sure people can make their own decisions about their health and family without shame, judgment, or stigma."

"There's a false dichotomy between people who believe in having abortion as a choice and people who believe it's important to provide prenatal care and resources for women who want to carry their pregnancies to term." Grossman-Kahn stated. "An integral part of reproductive justice is being able to receive resources for pregnancy — pregnancy should be a viable option, but not the only one."

MANY CPCs RECEIVE government support through federal abstinence and marriage promotion taxpayer funds, "Choose Life" license plates, and tax-credited donations. According to NARAL, an estimated $60 million of taxpayer money has gone to fund crisis pregnancy centers nationally. Twenty-three states have passed

laws that support CPCs, eleven states directly subsidize CPCs, and twenty states, through laws, state agencies, or publications, direct women to CPCs, according to NARAL.

An October 2016 ThinkProgress article exposed that seven states use federal money intended for welfare programs, called Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF), to fund CPCs. These states — Missouri, Indiana, Ohio, Pennsylvania, Michigan, North Dakota, and Texas, have directed a total of over $30 million to crisis pregnancy centers in the past year.

Though it is hard to regulate CPCs, California has taken the lead in ensuring that they are held accountable for the information that they spread. In October 2015, the state legislature passed the AB-775. Better known as the Reproductive FACT Act, the bill required crisis pregnancy centers to inform clients where they can acquire abortion, birth control, and prenatal care, and notify their clients if they do not have medical licenses.

CPCs have fought back, filing lawsuits that argue that the law is unconstitutional because it violates freedom of speech guaranteed by the First Amendment. However, the government has been able to regulate information circulated in certain areas, such as medicine and advertising. Therefore, it holds that it should be able to regulate the information spread by CPCs.

"California's statewide law is excellent," said Priscilla Smith '84 JD '91, Director of the Program for the Study of Reproductive Justice at Yale Law School's Information Society Project.

"California's law requires factual disclosure," Smith explained in an interview. "The main effort around trying to prevent deception is by states and local municipalities enacting these types of laws that require truthful information to be given at CPCs. They go after truth in advertising."

"I would like to see a law that requires a CPC to say, up front, whether it will give truthful, unbiased counseling or not," she continued. "But this principle [of regulating information spread by CPCs] is still being tested in courts."

In addition to addressing crisis pregnancy centers with legislation and lawsuits, pro-choice activists are seeking to raise awareness so that people learn which places to avoid when seeking reproductive care. James Owens, the States Communications Director at NARAL, emphasized the importance of local engagement to current activism.

"We're still at a point where if you tell people that there are these anti-choice organizations out there that take federal dollars and intimidate women out of getting abortions, people are shocked," said Owens. "People are not aware of anti-choice groups. They're not aware of this broad effort to push anti-choice ideology from a local level up."

He argues, however, that some aspects of reproductive justice are gaining national attention, in spite of what Owens calls the "steady creep of anti-abortion provisions being passed at the state and national levels." This new audience includes the Supreme Court. In this summer's Whole Women's Health v. Hellerstedt, the high court struck down two provisions in Texas law that shut down numerous abortion clinics in the state.

"CPCs are becoming part of the national conversation on reproductive justice," Owens continued. "People are much more receptive, and there's a lot more outrage against anti-abortion legislation."

In the coming years, the national debate about reproductive rights will increasingly center on the role of CPCs. The American public will have to decide whether or not they there is a place for pro-life, Christian pregnancy resources centers like the Saint Gianna Center. The result will depend on how Americans envision reproductive health and the very concept of informed choice.

photo by Alice Oh

white pride online

the new face of american racism

BY **JACOB MALINOWSKI**

STORMFRONT.ORG IS NOT your Reddit chatroom. "Every month is White history month," reads a banner on the homepage. Twelve million posts discuss eugenics, the American Nazi Party, and WWII Revisionism. Stormfront is a forum for over three hundred thousand white nationalists, and its ideas have begun to permeate from obscure parts of the internet to prominent conservative publications.

While most of the comments on Stormfront would normally be disregarded in the mainstream media, they have been welcomed by certain members of the alt-right: a political philosophy that embraces a more radical conservatism than the typical Republican party dogma.

To appeal to ordinary citizens, the alt-right attempts to normalize their ideas by refraining from using racial slurs and embracing concepts that appeal to reason like "race realism." Race realism is the idea that the races are biologically different, and thus some are superior to others. While typically false and misleading, this modernization of historically offensive rhetoric appeals to some Americans because it conceals their racist intentions.

Some members of the alt-right, however, believe their speech is being restricted by the public. "If I were a junior faculty at Yale, and I said some of the things publicly that I said to you, I would be fired," said Jared Taylor '73, founder and editor of American Renaissance, a race realism publication that advocates for whites. While some critics have called him a "crudely white supremacist," Taylor, a Timothy Dwight College alum, says this name-calling underscores the intolerance of our culture.

"Everyone should speak as candidly as possible. However, we live in a society that is far from being free," Taylor explained to *The Politic*. "People can lose their jobs simply because they express a certain point of view."

Taylor highlights a discussion of free speech and race relations—one that Yale students and others around the country are having today. It's difficult to hear every voice while maintaining a respectful and safe environment. So can we discuss race fairly?

"Leftist groups repress dissent on campus, but that's been going on for years because it's enabled by the university administrators," said Peter Brimelow, author and founder of VDARE, in an interview with *The Politic*. Brimelow's anti-immigration publication VDARE is a "hate website" according to the Southern Poverty Law Center (SPLC), a nonprofit which works to expose and demolish hate groups of all types.

"It's now essentially impossible to write frankly about immigration, let alone race, and remain in the mainstream media," said Brimelow. "The simplest thing is to assume you live in an occupied country and speak only to people you trust."

Many Americans only discuss their ideas online, and hateful comments are plentiful. "Blacks are dangerous by nature and the last thing you want is a black in your neighborhood," commented "awakenedrealist" on Stormfront. On an article about illegal immigration

posted on American Renaissance, a user named "DP" commented, "I am so sick of these 3d worlders from who knows where destroying our country."

Because many of these comments are anonymous, anti-hate groups occasionally struggle to target the source. Instead, they have responded by publishing personal information like home addresses and private emails of the more public individuals like Taylor and Brimelow.

"Our goal is to not merely chronicle these groups, but to destroy them. We say this openly, not as a secret," said Mark Potok, senior fellow at SPLC Intelligence Project, in an interview with *The Politic*. Potok, who once reported on the Oklahoma City Bombing, says SPLC primarily fights hate groups through the press.

"We frequently publish things that are very embarrassing and harmful to them," said Potok, "and if we can't destroy them this way, we marginalize them politically."

Daryle Lamont Jenkins, founder of One People's Project (OPP), agrees. The mission of OPP is similar to many other anti-hate organizations, but OPP takes a very direct approach and has interfered with various rallies and conferences. In fact, OPP helped to cancel one of Taylor's American Renaissance conferences in Washington D.C. In an interview with *The Politic*, Jenkins elaborated on OPP's methods.

"We have basically been able to neutralize a number of well-known hate groups. Because we were able to take the [white nationalist] conferences out of Washington D.C., it neutralized them somewhat," explained Jenkins.

"if i were a junior faculty at yale, and i said some of the things publically that i said to you, i would be fired"

But Jenkins is also open to acceptance. "It's like a 'speak softly and carry a big stick' policy with us," he said. Jenkins believes people are not born to hate. Rather, they come from impoverished or abusive situations and are received by hateful people.

"You have individuals who are trying to make their lives worth a damn. It's only a matter of who got to them first: The more positive elements or the more negative ones," Jenkins remarked.

Andy Friedland, assistant regional director for the Anti-Defamation League (ADL) has a plan to prevent white supremacy recruitment.

"We can have an open conversation with people where we don't punish, but instead work together with them," he said to *The Politic*. ADL's mission is to primarily stop the defamation of the Jewish people and inform the public on resources they have to deal with hateful speech. "When we see something we disagree with, we speak up and we speak up loudly," said Friedland.

Groups like the ADL, Stormfront, and OPP, however polarized they may seem, agree on the importance of free speech. "I probably value the First Amendment more than almost anyone; I would grant those privileges to everyone," said Taylor.

Friedland and the ADL agree. "We don't believe in suppressing other people's right to speech. We understand it's one of the most important parts of the U.S. Constitution," said Friedland.

This idea of free speech is valuable to both sides because it enables them to fully express their ideas. While some might argue that alt-right speech is

hate speech, Potok disagrees. "To call something hate speech is to describe speech you don't like," he said. His focus is not hate speech but what he labels "bogus speech."

"The most important thing is to show that their propaganda is absolutely false," explained Potok. "Surprise, surprise, the Holocaust actually happened. It's an absolute falsehood that gay men molest children at a higher rate than straight men, and it's utter hogwash that Muslims have a secret plan to implement Sharia law."

But Jared Taylor says that his allies are not the ones who restate falsehoods. Instead, according to Taylor, many liberals use faulty logic to discuss failed race relations and "fall back on all these ad hoc explanations that blame white people." And because his enemies restrict his right to speech, he has no platform to properly defend himself.

"My view of the world explains reality. Their view doesn't," asserted Taylor.

It's possible that voices are stifled or silenced—even at Yale. "I think younger people are in an impossible position," said Brimelow. And while young adults do write for his website, "all of VDARE.com's younger writers are pseudonymous," Brimelow continued.

Taylor agrees and said he is frustrated, but "[wishes] for a United States in which there is a genuine tolerance of dissent." And while it might be easy to disagree with his thoughts and rhetoric, it's almost undemocratic to fight this ideal.

Even Jenkins—the man who cancelled one of Taylor's conferences—agrees with him on this point. "The racism discussion has been ignored," he explained. It's possible that when an entire viewpoint is crushed, it removes the chance to don't fully debate the differences in opinion. And differences are important to Jenkins.

"Yes, we're going to come from different backgrounds. My vision of a perfect society is that we learn from them, that we appreciate them, that we don't disparage you, and that we don't deny you your freedoms," Jenkins stated.

Potok says that the discussion on race is difficult because of demographic change. "In 2043, we will be in a position [in the US] where no one race dominates," Potok explained, which could complicate how diversity is viewed in America. It's not perfect, Potok said, and "we'll never live in a world without hate," but America is close to something great. With open minds, American students might be able to effect and lead massive change.

"We're heading to such an ideal place," said Potok, "My hope is that at the end of this, we become this nation we've been trying to become for 300-plus years."

"our goal is to not merely chronicle these groups, but to destroy them.

we say this openly, not as a secret"

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Putin Glamour: Russia's It Girls Spread Trends and Political Propaganda

Russia's most fashionable "it girls" are as glamorous as the Kardashians, but they also have ties to oligarchs and the KGB. Sarina Xu '20 analyzes how the glamour of the Russian fashion world covers up Putin's political propaganda.

'What if Both Sides Are Bad?': Truths at War in Kashmir

With opposing accounts of the Kashmir conflict in Indian and Pakistani newspapers, it's almost impossible to know what is going on. The censorship even reaches pop culture — when Pakistan prohibited Bollywood movies, and Indian producers tried to ban all Pakistani actors. Sabrina Bustamante '20 goes back to the beginning to sss why the conflict devolved into confusion and how the Kashmiris lost themselves along the way.

The Frog Who Went Facist: Memes and the Alt-Right

In a stunning turn of events, Pepe the Frog, once an innocuous meme, has become a recognized hate symbol and important piece of neo-Nazi iconography. Katie Kidney ('19) explores the processes by which we derive political meanings from symbols-- and explains how an innocent frog went so terribly off course.

Encounters in the Park: An Exhibition on Yosemite National Park at the Yale University Art Gallery

A new exhibit, curated jointly by the Yale University Art Gallery and the Peabody Museum, celebrates the history of Yosemite National Park through the lenses of both art and science. In addition to offering an inspiring tribute to Yosemite's natural beauty, the exhibit reveals the surprisingly rich historical connection between the park and this very university.

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The MacMillan Center extracurricular programs deepen and extend this research-teaching nexus of faculty and students at Yale, with more than 700 lectures, conferences, workshops, roundtables, symposia, film, and art events each year. Virtually all of these are open to the community at large. Its annual flagship lectures, the Coca-Cola World Fund Lecture and the George Herbert Walker, Jr. Lecture in International Studies, bring a number of prominent scholars and political figures to the Yale campus.

The MacMillan Report

The MacMillan Center produces *The MacMillan Report*, an Internet show that showcases Yale faculty in international and areas studies and their research in a one-on-one interview format. Webisodes can be viewed at macmillanreport.yale.edu.

YaleGlobal Online

This publication disseminates information about globalization to millions of readers in more than 215 countries around the world. *YaleGlobal* publishes original articles aimed at the wider public, authored by Yale faculty, world leaders, major foreign policy figures, and top specialists in politics, economics, diplomacy, business, health, and the environment.

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